

Iran War Risk

Pillar Report

Middle East Conflict Risk — Researched, Scored, and Personally Committed

Originally written June 19, 2026; scores committed by me June 19, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026, and again as a full weekly refresh on August 8, 2026 (P cut at 1mo/3mo, 24/31/41/56/77 → 20/28/41/56/77, committed and stamped by Alex, last COMMITTED baseline). The Aug 16-22 gap saw four abandoned drafts: Aug 17 (held flat), Aug 18 (cut to 17/25/38/54/76), Aug 20 (cut to 16/24/38/54/76, left for manual review over a UAE missile claim), and Aug 21 (a session got partway through delivering the Aug 20 numbers — 2 of 6 reports touched, no render/selfcheck/archive/commit — before stopping). None were rendered, archived, or committed. An Aug 22 morning catch-up cycle (score set **2026-08-22_draft**) independently re-verified the gap via four parallel primary-source research passes, then adversarially fact-checked the load-bearing new claims before delivery — a step that caught a real error (see below) — and cut P to 14/22/38/54/76, delivered as a draft flagged for manual review. **Correction #1 (confirmed accurate):** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only, Iran denies and calls it a possible "false flag") and was NOT the first direct attack on the UAE as prior drafts framed it — UAE was hit by a missile/drone barrage Apr 1-8 and again at its Fujairah port May 4, both Iran-attributed by UAE's own government and predating Aug 18; that "novel escalation vector" framing is retired. **Correction #2 (a genuine miss, caught on adversarial re-check):** that draft initially described a fatal strike on the bulker Minoan Dignity (chief engineer killed, Aug 17-18) as "the first confirmed fatality" in the Hormuz tanker campaign — that is FALSE; it is one of a cumulative toll of seafarer deaths since the campaign began late February 2026 this report never previously surfaced or scored on. The Iranian vessel seizure (tanker Amara, held near Qeshm Island since Aug 17, first since June 22) IS confirmed accurate. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-22_draft2) is a separate, later-in-the-day FULL WEEKLY refresh** — the first deep multi-source dive since Aug 8 — that independently re-researched the pillar and ran a second, dedicated adversarial-verification pass specifically re-checking (a) whether the casualty-toll figure holds up and (b) whether anything was missed Aug 19-22. It holds up, but softer than a clean number: cross-checking Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (18 total), a mid-July gCaptain snapshot ("at least 15"), and IMO's own incident tracker (19 seafarer deaths, but scoped to the broader Middle East, not Hormuz cleanly) puts the honest range at **15-19 cumulative deaths (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers)**, not a flat "18th death" — that softened framing is carried everywhere below. A UAE missile-attack claim the adversarial pass initially flagged as a possible miss turned out, on reconciliation, to be the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline, not a second incident. No new kinetic incident was found Aug 19-22. **P HELD FLAT this cycle at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as draft at delivery (full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from auto-stamp), then reviewed and COMMITTED BY ALEX on August 23** after independent re-verification of the math and the research trail; see My Decision below. A daily catch-up draft dated August 28, 2026 (score set **2026-08-28_draft**) re-checked two more Hormuz tanker incidents and a single-source Iran-Oman revenue-sharing claim, holding P flat — but that draft was never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed, and is treated as abandoned/superseded, the same discipline this report has applied to every other interrupted session (Aug 17, 18, 20, and 21). **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-29_draft) is a NEW, independent FULL WEEKLY refresh** against the last committed baseline (2026-08-22_draft2) — the first cycle in several weeks to surface a genuinely two-sided evidence ledger: a confirmed, crypto-specific sanctions escalation (the Aug 24 "Operation Economic Outcast" package, the first Iran sanctions action to explicitly name digital assets as a sanctionable sector and list 30 on-chain addresses, confirmed via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov) against a confirmed de-escalation upgrade (Oman's own Foreign Ministry, not just Iran, co-confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor Aug 25, confirmed via direct fetch of fm.gov.om). The two roughly offset, alongside a first-of-the-crisis Hormuz transit uptick and a second straight weekly Brent decline on the bull side, and two more tanker incidents plus a firmer casualty count on the bear side. **P HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as a draft, not auto-stamped**, because this is a full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size (here, zero). See My Decision below. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-31_draft) is a light daily catch-up** covering the Aug 29-31 gap: on Aug 30, US forces struck IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Iran's Larak Island — the first US strike on Iranian territory since Jul 29 — directly firing this pillar's own pre-declared flip line ("a

resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper"). Iran retaliated with ballistic missiles on two US-linked Jordan airbases hours later; Jordan intercepted 8 missiles; no confirmed US casualty. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 9/17/34/51/75** (from 14/22/38/54/76), front-loaded and held under 8 points per window. This is a light daily touch, not a full weekly refresh, no window moved >8 points, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip vs. the last stamped set — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-01_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Aug 31-Sept 1: escalation continued into a second day — a THIRD Hormuz tanker hit (the VLCC Senegal Prosperity, Aug 31), a disputed Iranian claim of a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base (UAE MoD denies the target claim but confirms it intercepted an Iranian drone over its waters), and Trump on-record Aug 31 still weighing further strikes on Iran. **P RE-RATED DOWN again, more modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75** (from 9/17/34/51/75) — no window moved more than 2 points, well under the 8-point auto-stamp threshold. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated authority** — the new last COMMITTED baseline. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-02_draft) is a further light daily catch-up that turned into the sharpest single-cycle move since Aug 30:** CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran — roughly 50x the scale of the single Aug 30 Larak strike — including, for the first time in this war, direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a new "tanker for tanker" policy. A US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Kuhestak, Hormozgan (4+ dead per the Hormozgan governor's office, including a 4-year-old, 60+ injured) — flagged here as SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact level (Iranian state/local authorities; CENTCOM has neither confirmed nor denied it), so it does not by itself move P, but it is the reported trigger for Iran's response: coordinated IRGC ballistic-missile/drone strikes Sept 2 on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — larger in scale than the single-state Aug 30-31 Jordan strike, but all four are repeat targets, so the "widening to a further NEW state" flip-line clause does not fire. **P RE-RATED DOWN sharply to 1/9/27/47/74** (from 7/15/32/50/75), front-loaded and kept under 8 points per window. **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026,** retroactively, under Alex's Sept 3 widened delegated daily auto-stamp policy: a call-band flip and the size of a move are no longer disqualifying on their own. The wedding-casualty fact was correctly kept single-narrative-sourced and never used to move P, and nothing about the sourcing or the research itself changed — only the stamping threshold did. This remains the last TRUE committed baseline: 1/9/27/47/74. **Sept 3:** Iran fired a second retaliatory wave on Kuwait and UAE — both repeat targets, no US-manned facility hit, widening clause does not fire. **P HELD FLAT. Sept 5, light daily catch-up (2026-09-05_draft):** held flat again — the Reuters weapons-expert corroboration of the Sept 1 wedding strike resolves attribution of an already-priced event, not new escalation; a Sept 5 Iranian-media report of a US strike on the tanker STARK 1 near Kharg Island is single-narrative and not used to move P. **CORRECTION:** that cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED," but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced to committed — a bug in that session, flagged here, not corrected retroactively. **Sept 5, FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2), this version:** independently re-verified via WebSearch — the STARK 1 incident is real and developing (Iran International separately obtained video of US radio warnings, and AP itself frames it as an Iranian accusation, not a confirmed fact) but CENTCOM has still not confirmed or denied it, so per the sufficiency rule it is NOT used to move P. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fired this week. **HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74. Full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy — left for manual review, and COMMITTED BY ALEX September 5, 2026. Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft):** CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release now confirms the Sept 5 tanker strike this report had withheld pending confirmation — and reveals it was materially more serious than known: THREE Iranian tankers (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kylo) struck in retaliation for an unprovoked IRGC ballistic-missile attack on two US Navy warships, both of which evaded. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73** — no window moved more than 2 points, no flip-line clause independently fires (no confirmed US casualty, no widening to a new state, Brent short of \$100), and the master call band held Neutral → Neutral. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-08_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 6-8: the new fact is Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei's on-record Sept 6-7 announcement (state TV, Press TV, Tehran Times) that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning any vessel that enters — corroborated by 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu, GlobalSecurity.org) but explicitly a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed ("further details... yet to be announced" per Al Jazeera's Sept 7 explainer). No flip-line clause fires (DCAS still 18, Brent ~\$97.29 Sept 7, no new state). **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73** (from 1/8/25/45/73) — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-09_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 8-9: CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship") confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers on Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman) and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days, corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org); both Iranian missile attempts were evaded, no US personnel harmed. Separately, Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24 (CNBC, ABC News; ~\$100.44, +2.57%) — a single-day intraday cross, not this pillar's own "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line threshold, so it does not independently fire that clause, but it is the

closest this cycle has come to the flip line. No flip-line clause fires (no US casualty, no new state, only an intraday Brent cross). **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72** (from 1/7/24/44/73) — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-10_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 9-10: two new dated facts. CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC retaliated for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by firing 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq air base — 18 intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org, Jordan's own military). Jordan is a repeat target, so the widening clause does not fire, and both sides confirm no casualties, so the US-casualty clause does not fire either. Separately, Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10, closing in on the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a second global chokepoint distinct from Hormuz — confirmed by 5+ outlets (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, SCMP, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail), but the same Houthi/Yemen actor already priced, and no strait closure has actually been executed, so this does not independently fire a clause either. Brent has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session (CNBC: above \$101 Sept 9; TradingEconomics: ~\$101.25 Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross, the closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but still short of a clean sustained-close call. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from 1/6/23/43/72) — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral). **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-11_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 10-11: this pillar's own "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause FIRES on a third consecutive session — Brent closed Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday, its highest since May 19, with WTI closing above \$102 for the first time since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent) — alongside fuller reporting of Iran's Sept 9 shipping wave: 10 vessels attacked near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers), the largest declared wave of the war, with at least one seafarer killed and one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does not fire. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71** (from 1/5/22/42/72) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. No window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar on every scored fact, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip anywhere. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-12_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 11-12: Houthi forces, having seized Mocha Sept 10, swept the rest of Yemen's Red Sea coastline by Sept 11 — capturing the final government-held coastal towns (Dhubab, Murad) and Houthi naval forces seizing Mayyun (Perim) Island in the Bab al-Mandeb strait itself, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island — a materially more severe status (actual control of a second global chokepoint's own islands) than the Sept 10 baseline's "closing in" characterization, confirmed by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald). Separately, UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 confirms four projectiles struck two more vessels near Khasab, Oman Sept 10, one set afire (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill corroborating); an IRGC claim of a Sairdrone strike is single-source and not used to move P. Yemen is an existing theater, so the widening clause does not fire; no US casualty, so that clause doesn't either — this is a severity escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment, not a fresh clause firing. **P RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70** (from 1/4/20/40/71) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". See My Decision below.

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 20% OF MY THESIS (EQUAL, 1/5)

Written June 19, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified September 12, 2026 — light daily catch-up, score set 2026-09-12_draft (P re-rated down moderately to 1/2/18/38/70; Houthi forces sweep the rest of Yeme Mayyun Island — a second global chokepoint moving from "under threat" to under adversary-aligned control — alongside a UKMTO-confirmed strike on two more vessels near Khasab, Oman) · COMMIT committed: Sept 11 (2026-09-11_draft), auto-stamped · Not Financial Advice

The Scores — Committed vs. Drafts

June column committed by me June 19, 2026 · Aug 8 (cut at 1mo/3mo, full weekly refresh) committed and stamped by Alex · Aug 9-16 are light daily touches, all held flat (no cycle ran Aug 15) · Aug 17-21 drafted but never delivered adversarial passes, cut to 14/22/38/54/76, HELD FLAT vs. the morning draft) was left as a draft at delivery (full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from auto-stamp) and **COMMITTED BY ALEX August 23, 2026**. An Aug 28 daily rendered/selfchecked/archived/committed — abandoned/superseded. An Aug 29 full weekly refresh independently re-researched the week and also HELD P flat at 14/22/38/54/76, left as a draft (full weekly refreshes are categorically draft is now superseded and collapses out of this table per house rules on committed sets. **Aug 31 (2026-08-31_draft)** was a light daily catch-up covering Aug 29-31: a resumed direct US strike on Iranian territory (Larak Island, Aug 30) airbases fired this pillar's own pre-declared downside flip line — P cut to 9/17/34/51/75, AUTO-STAMPED. **Sept 1 (2026-09-01_draft)** was a further light daily catch-up covering Aug 31-Sept 1: escalation continued into a second day STAMPED, the last COMMITTED set. **This section (score set 2026-09-02_draft) covers Sept 1-2:** the conflict escalated materially — CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 targets across Iran (~50x the scale of the Aug 30 government oil tankers; a US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Hormozgan (single-narrative-sourced, not scored directly); Iran's IRGC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated strikes on FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, **RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY to 1/9/27/47/74** — front-loaded, kept under 8 points per window. Originally left as draft Sept 2 pending Alex's manual review (single-narrative core fact, genuinely novel scale, both sides threatening (Neutral); **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026** once Alex widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy so a call-band flip and move size no longer withhold the stamp on their own — this is the last TRUE committed both repeat targets; P HELD FLAT. **Sept 5 (2026-09-05_draft)** held flat again; that cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED," but config/scores.json's status was never actually advanced — flagged as a correction, not itself a **version**) independently re-verifies via WebSearch, including the Sept 5 STARK 1/Kharg Island tanker report (still unconfirmed by CENTCOM, not used to move P); categorically excluded from daily auto-stamp authority, so it went to 1. **Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft)** re-rates P down modestly to 1/8/25/45/73 once CENTCOM's own press release confirmed the Sept 5 tanker strike as a 3-tanker retaliation for an IRGC missile attack on 2 call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral); **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new committed baseline. **Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08_draft)** re-rates P down modestly again to 1/7/24/44/72 of intent to declare a restricted zone beyond Hormuz into the Persian Gulf — a genuine new escalatory signal, corroborated by 8+ independent outlets, but a threat of intent, not yet executed — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the committed baseline. **Sept 9 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-09_draft, this version)** re-rates P down modestly again to 1/6/23/43/72: CENTCOM's own press release confirmed (M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco, M/T Derya) after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles twice — corroborated by 5+ independent outlets — and Brent crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for sustained-\$100 flip line. No window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline. **Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft)** re-rates P down, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72: the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq air base in retaliation for the Sept 8 tanker strike (18 intercepted, no casualties), and Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha, closing in on an actor/theater already priced; Brent traded above \$100 for a second straight session, still short of a sustained close. No window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline. **Sept 11 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-11_draft)** re-rates P down, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71: this pillar's own "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause fires on a third consecutive session (Brent closed above \$107 Thursday Sept 10-vessel Sept 9 Hormuz shipping wave (at least one seafarer killed, not a US service member). No window moved more than 2 points, master call band unchanged everywhere — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline. **Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft)** re-rates P down, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70: Houthi forces swept the rest of Yemen's Red Sea coastline by Sept 11 (capturing Dhubab and Murad, the last government-held coastal towns) and seized the island of continuing for Zuqar Island — a second global chokepoint moving from "closing in on" to actual island-level control, confirmed by 6+ independent outlets; separately UKMTO confirms two more vessels struck near Khasab, Oman Sept 11 (no US theater; no US casualty), but this is a bigger step than the routine daily grind — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline. See My Decision below.

WINDOW	JUN	...	8/22 (COMMITTED)	8/31 (COMMITTED)	9/1 (COMMITTED)	9/2 (COMMITTED)	9/5 D2 (COMMITTED)	9/6 (COMMITTED)	9/8 (COMMITTED)	9/9	9/10	9/11 (COMMITTED)	9/12 (COMMITTED)
1 month	50	...	14	9	7	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
3 months	55	...	22	17	15	9	9	8	7	6	5	4	2
6 months	62	...	38	34	32	27	27	25	24	23	22	20	18
1 year	75	...	54	51	50	47	47	45	44	43	42	40	38
3 years	85	...	76	75	75	74	74	73	73	72	72	71	70

P — the odds this is *good for crypto* by then. **THIS CYCLE** (Sept 12, score set 2026-09-12_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70 (from the Sept 11-committed 1/4/20/40).

Prior cycle (Sept 11, score set 2026-09-11_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71 (from the Sept 10-committed 1/5/22/42/72). BEARISH and NEW — a second, distinct f

Prior cycle (Sept 10, score set 2026-09-10_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72 (from the Sept 9-committed 1/6/23/43/72). Two new dated facts. BEARISH and NEW: C

Prior to this cycle (Sept 9, score set 2026-09-09_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72 (from the Sept 8-committed 1/7/24/44/73). BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM

Prior to this cycle (Sept 8, score set 2026-09-08_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73 (from the Sept 6-committed 1/8/25/45/73). BEARISH and NEW: Iran's SNS

CoinPicks · September 12, 2026 · Research & Education · Not Financial Advice

Prior to this cycle (Sept 6 light daily catch-up, score set 2026-09-06 draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73 (from the Sept 5-committed 1/9/27/47/74). **BEARISH** and **this report withheld from moving P is now CENTCOM-confirmed, and is more serious than known.** CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil, corroborated by Al Arabiya and independent outlets) states US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers on Sept 5 — M/T Downy (permanently disabled off Kharg Island), M/T Stark 1 (permanently disabled near Jask, and another M/T (permanently disabled near Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (an aircraft carrier and a guided-missile destroyer); both ships evaded multiple attacks, no American personnel were killed. CENTCOM commander: "If you shoot at two of our ships, we will impose an even higher economic cost — taking out three of yours." This clears the sufficiency bar the Sept 5 baseline explicitly withheld from moving P (AP framing it as an accusation and CENTCOM silent) — it is now primary-sourced and multiply corroborated, and it reveals a materially more serious escalation than a quiet single-tanker intercept. The Sept 5 US Navy vessels. Separately, Sept 6 (today) IRGC claims of further strikes on three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels and a US naval drone in the Strait of Hormuz (Al Jazeera's live broadcast, Sept 6, US-confirmed, so per the sufficiency rule they are NOT independently used to move P; watch next cycle. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fire: no confirmed new US combat deaths (standing count), no widening to a further new state (Kharg Island, Jask, and the Gulf of Oman are all existing theater), and Brent closed ~\$96/bbl Friday Sept 4 (US/UK markets closed Saturday Sept 4). The cut is sized as a confirmed-escalation/severity-upgrade to an already-known event, not a fresh flip-line shock, and kept small: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -3, 36mo -4, window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per house discipline, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Prior to this cycle: P was RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY to 1/9/27/47/74 (Sept 2, committed Sept 3, then HELD FLAT through Sept 3's Kuwait/UAE repeat-target strikes and the Sept 5 full weekly refresh above for that flat-hold history) (from the Sept 1-committed 7/15/32/50/75) — researched Sept 2, **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026** under Alex's widened daily auto-stamped flip-line **bearing new fact: the conflict escalated materially Sept 1-2, confirming exactly the risk this pillar's own Sept 1 note flagged.** CENTCOM confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 targets across Iraq, Iran, and Oman, including mine-laying capability, communications sites, and anti-ship cruise-missile/drone launchers — roughly 50x the scale of the single Aug 30 Larak Island strike (multi-source: Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, Reuters, Newsweek, ABC News, Al Jazeera, Fox News, RFE/RL, Epoch Times, Daily Caller, OANN, FXStreet, Korea Times, India TV, Time). Iran's army (not IRGC) struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms), under a newly reported Trump-approved "tanker for tanker" policy, a marked shift from the prior posture of intercepting attacks. The Sept 2 cut is sized as a confirmed-escalation/severity-upgrade to an already-known event, not a fresh flip-line shock, and kept small: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -3, 36mo -4, window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per house discipline, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

September 3, 2026, Alex reviewed this cycle and widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy: a call-band flip and move size are no longer disqualifying by themselves. The underlying fact set is unchanged — the wedding-casualty claim still was not used to move P — only the stamping threshold changed. **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026.** See My Decision below.

Prior to this cycle (Sept 1 light daily catch-up): P was RE-RATED DOWN to 7/15/32/50/75 (from the Aug 31-committed 9/17/34/51/75) — AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. **BEARISH** and **fact then: escalation continued into a second day.** The Aug 30-31 cut (see below) was explicitly sized on the assumption that "one resumed-strike night is not yet a sustained new campaign, so the next. A THIRD Hormuz tanker was hit Aug 31: the Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity, struck by three unknown projectiles ~17 nautical miles northeast of Khasab, Oman, during outbound transit, no casualties, no environmental impact reported; UKMTO-logged. This follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25) incidents. Iran's army (not IRGC) struck a US Navy warship (the USS Zumwalt) near Dubai; the UAE Ministry of Defense explicitly DENIED that Al Minhad was targeted, while separately confirming its air force intercepted an Iranian drone detected over UAE territorial waters, but a CONFIRMED cross-border drone incursion, a genuine (if unconfirmed-as-a-hit) attempt to widen beyond the repeat-target Jordan pattern. Jordan was struck again Aug 30-31, but the Sept 1 cut is sized as a confirmed-escalation/severity-upgrade to an already-known event, not a fresh flip-line shock, and kept small: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -3, 36mo -4, window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per house discipline, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

"further new" state per this pillar's own framing. President Trump said on-record Aug 31 he is still weighing further strikes on Iran, calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo, Reuters, Newsweek, ABC News, Al Jazeera, Fox News, RFE/RL, Epoch Times, Daily Caller, OANN, FXStreet, Korea Times, India TV, Time). This was the first acknowledgment of a "little war" signaling de-escalation. Brent crude continued higher into Sept 1 (~+2% Tuesday per multiple market-desk reports) on fresh-clash fears — the session after the long Labor Day weekend, the first time since the Sept 5 cut. No new confirmed US casualty, and no confirmed hit on UAE territory (UAE denies), so this does NOT independently fire a fresh flip-line clause on its own — neither the "confirmed new US combat deaths" clause fires cleanly. This is a continuation/erosion of the "single incident" framing, not a fresh shock of comparable size to the Aug 30-31 cut itself — hence the small move, well under the 17→15, 6mo 34→32, 12mo 51→50, 36mo 75→75 (flat). Corroborated across CBS News, Al Jazeera, Breitbart, Yahoo, Jerusalem Post, ABC News, Seatrade Maritime, Iran International, and UKMTO's rocket/mine-launchers on Larak Island in the Strait of Hormuz after observing preparations to fire sea mines into the strait — CENTCOM spokesperson Capt. Tim Hawkins confirmed on the record (Bloomberg, CNBC, NBC News, Reuters, Newsweek, ABC News, Al Jazeera, Fox News, RFE/RL, Epoch Times, Daily Caller, OANN, FXStreet, Korea Times, India TV, Time). This was the first acknowledgment of a "little war" ending the ~28-30-consecutive-clean-night streak the Aug 29 baseline explicitly cited as part of its bullish case, and it directly fired this pillar's own pre-declared downside flip line ("a resumption of hostilities, dip-buy thesis as broken") — not a novel judgment call, a pre-committed trigger firing exactly as written. IRGC confirmed Iranian soldiers/civilians killed or wounded at Larak (no precise toll given), and the Sept 1 cut is sized as a confirmed-escalation/severity-upgrade to an already-known event, not a fresh flip-line shock, and kept small: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -3, 36mo -4, window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per house discipline, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

ballistic missiles at two US-linked airbases in Jordan (King Hussein, Al-Azraq); Jordan's military said it intercepted 8 missiles, and Iran claims "heavy damage" to base infrastructure — unconfirmed by Jordan, logged as Iran-sourced, not scored as fact. That cut was front-loaded and held under 8 points per window, sized similarly to the Jul 28 Jordan-strike precedent for a comparable single-incident escalation. The Sept 1 cut is sized as a confirmed-escalation/severity-upgrade to an already-known event, not a fresh flip-line shock, and kept small: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -3, 36mo -4, window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per house discipline, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

54→51 and 36mo 76→75. Prior to that, the Aug 29 full weekly refresh had held P flat at 14/22/38/54/76 on a genuinely two-sided ledger: **BEARISH and CONFIRMED: the "Operation Economic Dawn"** fetched from home.treasury.gov: press release sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iranian Regime on Economic D-Day") and sb0614 (Bessent's remarks), plus an OFAC statement corroborated by state.gov and 3+ independent trade-compliance/crypto-intelligence outlets (TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes) plus law-firm client alerts. ~60 entities/individuals/vessels were sanctioned in the UAE, Singapore, and Switzerland under five sectoral determinations (EO 13902). Critically, this is the FIRST TIME digital assets was explicitly named as a sanctionable sector under this program. Bitcoin, Ethereum, and TRON were listed. Unlike the sanctions this pillar tracked in prior cycles as "promised but not landed" (Bessent's rhetoric through Aug 22), this is real, primary-confirmed, and directly crypto-relevant. The Sept 1 cut is sized as a confirmed-escalation/severity-upgrade to an already-known event, not a fresh flip-line shock, and kept small: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -3, 36mo -4, window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per house discipline, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

with a new Bank Melli-Dubai designation. Two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents fired this window: Aug 24 off Oman (engine-room damage, disabled, no casualties, UKMTO-logged as Iran-sourced, not scored as fact. That cut was front-loaded and held under 8 points per window, sized similarly to the Jul 28 Jordan-strike precedent for a comparable single-incident escalation. The Sept 1 cut is sized as a confirmed-escalation/severity-upgrade to an already-known event, not a fresh flip-line shock, and kept small: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -3, 36mo -4, window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per house discipline, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

— both comparable in severity to the already-established pattern. CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper gave an on-record briefing Aug 28 (corroborated by UPI, The National, Washington Post, Reuters, Newsweek, ABC News, Al Jazeera, Fox News, RFE/RL, Epoch Times, Daily Caller, OANN, FXStreet, Korea Times, India TV, Time). This was the first acknowledgment of a "little war" cleared Iranian sea mines from the internationally-recognized shipping lanes; ~1,500 commercial vessels have transited since blockade enforcement began; ~75 vessels turned back and 3 disabled. The Sept 1 cut is sized as a confirmed-escalation/severity-upgrade to an already-known event, not a fresh flip-line shock, and kept small: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -3, 36mo -4, window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per house discipline, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

exported from Iran since the blockade resumed — read as continuation/intensification of an existing posture, not a new shock. IMO's six-month casualty count (Aug 28, quasi-primary IMO briefing) shows 54 dead (seafarers + port workers) across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the previously-reported 15-19 range, a slight negative confirmation, not a new shock. **BULLISH and CONFIRMED: the "Operation Economic Dawn"** fetched from home.treasury.gov: press release sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iranian Regime on Economic D-Day") and sb0614 (Bessent's remarks), plus an OFAC statement corroborated by state.gov and 3+ independent trade-compliance/crypto-intelligence outlets (TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes) plus law-firm client alerts. ~60 entities/individuals/vessels were sanctioned in the UAE, Singapore, and Switzerland under five sectoral determinations (EO 13902). Critically, this is the FIRST TIME digital assets was explicitly named as a sanctionable sector under this program. Bitcoin, Ethereum, and TRON were listed. Unlike the sanctions this pillar tracked in prior cycles as "promised but not landed" (Bessent's rhetoric through Aug 22), this is real, primary-confirmed, and directly crypto-relevant. The Sept 1 cut is sized as a confirmed-escalation/severity-upgrade to an already-known event, not a fresh flip-line shock, and kept small: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -3, 36mo -4, window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per house discipline, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Hormuz corridor, Aug 25. Directly fetched from fm.gov.om/en/53722 (Oman's own government site) — a genuine upgrade, because in every prior cycle only Iran claimed a Hormuz deal and the US denied it. ministry co-hosts the statement. Terms: a temporary 7-mile-wide joint navigational corridor (entry/exit through Iranian waters), a joint mine-clearing project, and continuing technical talks toward a permanent deal. Memorandum. Still explicitly described as "temporary" — Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance with the lapsed June MoU. No public fee/revenue terms were announced. The Sept 1 cut is sized as a confirmed-escalation/severity-upgrade to an already-known event, not a fresh flip-line shock, and kept small: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -3, 36mo -4, window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per house discipline, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

spokesman claim (Aug 26) of an Iran-Oman revenue-sharing deal remains single-source and unconfirmed by Oman — correctly excluded from scoring, same treatment as prior single-source claim. The Sept 1 cut is sized as a confirmed-escalation/severity-upgrade to an already-known event, not a fresh flip-line shock, and kept small: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -3, 36mo -4, window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per house discipline, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

zero-tolerance policy on new mines Aug 25 (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 tanker attack above. The first quantified Hormuz transit-volume increase was the week of Aug 17-23 (USNI News, citing Lloyd's List Intelligence — quasi-primary shipping data, 2 independent pieces Aug 21 & Aug 28) — 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound 29, eastbound 88, 130/day (~770-910/week) pre-war baseline, but the first confirmed uptick of the whole crisis. Brent eased for a SECOND straight week: ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27, weekly loss of ~\$1.10, 95 (Aug 20-21), moving further away from the \$100/bbl flip line, with press explicitly framing it as "war premium unwinding" on the Hormuz progress. No new confirmed US combat death Aug 27. Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton, was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the standing casualty total, not a new event) — the flip line remains unfired. No new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran Aug 27 (checked Aug 27) confirms a 28th consecutive night with no confirmed strike. **Net assessment: the new escalation and the new de-escalation roughly offset.** The pillar's own explicit upside thesis (holding a full clean week without a new attack/fatality/seizure — is NOT met, since the Aug 27 attack breaks the "clean week" clause and the corridor deal remains Iran+Oman only (not US-accessible)) is not met. The Sept 1 cut is sized as a confirmed-escalation/severity-upgrade to an already-known event, not a fresh flip-line shock, and kept small: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -3, 36mo -4, window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per house discipline, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

discipline against chasing single-cycle mixed signals in either direction: P HELD FLAT on all five windows.

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. This cycle's load-bearing fact — the Bab al-Mandeb chokepoint seizure — is corroborated across 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNN, Bloomberg, Reuters, Newsweek, ABC News, Al Jazeera, Fox News, RFE/RL, Epoch Times, Daily Caller, OANN, FXStreet, Korea Times, India TV, Time). This was the first acknowledgment of a "little war" Khasab vessel strikes are confirmed via UKMTO's own official warning plus 3+ independent outlets, both well above the sufficiency bar. Quality (the 0-1 input) is unchanged this cycle per house discipline.

Impact — 8 out of 10, the uniform value shared by every pillar in the equal-weight model. BTC traded at \$77,289.66 on Sept 12, up modestly from \$77,063.25 on Sept 11 and \$77,993.99 on Sept 10. The Sept 1 cut is sized as a confirmed-escalation/severity-upgrade to an already-known event, not a fresh flip-line shock, and kept small: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -3, 36mo -4, window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per house discipline, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

up even as this pillar's own evidence moved further negative; per house discipline this pillar's score is not adjusted to chase or match the tape either way. For context, BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 9, a real, visible risk-off pullback logged when this pillar's evidence last moved sharply negative.

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated September 12, 2026 (re-checked Sept 12, P re-rated down moderately as a second global chokepoint moves under adversary-aligned control)

As of September 12, 2026 — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. This is a light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft) vs the Sept 11 committed baseline; this cycle's findings appear first, then facts carried forward from

- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha on Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait**, a SECOND global shipping chokepoint, independent outlets (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail). Same actor/theater already priced; no strait closure or interdiction has "closing in on," not as having executed a blockade.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent crude has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session**, more persistent than Sept 9's single-day intraday cross (CNBC: above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9 ~\$101.25 Thursday Sept 10) — the closest this cycle has come to this pillar's "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line clause, but still short of a clean multi-session sustained call.
- **NEW — no widening to a further new state and no confirmed US casualty**: Jordan is a repeat target, and CENTCOM/Jordan both confirm no casualties from the Al Azraq strike; DCAS removed aggregator's claim of a fresh KIA figure was checked and rejected as uncorroborated against CENTCOM's own statement).
- **BTC traded at \$77,063 on Sept 11** — down from \$77,993.99 on Sept 10 and \$79,052.40 on Sept 9 (local full quant refresh this cycle, run .py quant).

Carried forward from Sept 9 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ ★ **NEW — CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Dabir Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days**. Corroborated across 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship") — clears the sufficiency bar.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24**, trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) on U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strike fears (CNBC "Brent crude tops \$100 as U.S. Navy strikes Iran" News) — a single-day intraday cross, not a sustained close, so it does not independently fire this pillar's "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line clause; the closest this cycle has come to it.
- **NEW — both Iranian missile attempts on the US Navy warship were evaded, no US personnel harmed** — the confirmed-US-casualty flip-line clause remains unfired.
- **NEW — no widening to a further new state**: Gulf of Oman and Kharg Island are both existing theater already struck in this war.
- **Iran's Sept 6-7 SNSC "restricted zone" announcement remains not-yet-executed** — no new dated development, not re-scored a second time.
- **BTC traded at \$79,052.40 on Sept 9** — up from \$78,435.62 on Sept 8 and \$79,090.41 on Sept 7 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 8 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced on-record, Sept 6-7, that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" beyond the Strait of Hormuz "in the coming days."** The zone would include parts of the Persian Gulf; any vessel entering it would be placed on Iran's sanctions list. Corroborated across 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WP) and state media (Press TV, Tehran Times) — clears the sufficiency bar.
- **This is a threat of intent, not yet executed**: Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer states "further details, including the precise boundaries, have yet to be announced." Rezaei separately said an Iranian "in the coming days" — also not yet done as of this research pass.
- **GlobalSecurity's Day 192 (Sept 7) tracker puts the blockade count at 92 vessels redirected, 3 disabled, 2 boarded** — up from Day 190's 87/3/2 (Sept 3), a continuation of the already-priced.
- **BTC traded at \$78,435.62 on Sept 8** — down from \$79,090.41 on Sept 7 and \$80,338.98 on Sept 6 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 6 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil) confirms US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers Sept 5, resolving the tanker report this pillar had withheld previously** (disabled off Kharg Island), M/T Stark 1 (permanently disabled near Jask), and M/T Kylo (completely destroyed in the Gulf of Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy destroyers, both of which evaded multiple attacks with no American personnel harmed. Corroborated by Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC, and 5+ other independent outlets, in addition to CENTCOM's own report.
- ★ **This revealed a materially more serious escalation than the Sept 5 baseline knew**: not a quiet single-tanker interdiction, but a direct, unprovoked IRGC missile attack on US Navy vessels and a US Navy helicopter (Cooper (CENTCOM commander): "If you shoot at two of our ships, we will impose an even higher economic cost — taking out three of yours."
- **Sept 6's IRGC claims of further strikes on three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels and a US naval drone** (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews) remain US-unconfirmed as of this cycle.
- **BTC traded at \$79,929.30 on Sept 6** — up from \$79,646.11 on Sept 5 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 2 (re-verified through the Sept 5 full weekly refresh and this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran, roughly 50x the scale of the Aug 30 Larak Island strike**. Targets included IRGC air-defense sites, radar installations, and anti-ship cruise-missile and drone launchers. Multi-source corroborated: Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI.
- ★ ★ **NEW — for the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms), under a newly reported Trump-approved "tanker for tanker" policy —** Iranian attacks on third-party shipping to direct strikes on Iranian state vessels.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent rose ~5% Tuesday Sept 1, its best session in 5 weeks, to ~\$95-96.6/bbl; WTI to ~\$91-92** — still short of the \$100/bbl flip line.
- ★ ★ **NEW, FLAGGED SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED — a US strike on Kuestak, Sirik County, Hormozgan (near the Strait) reportedly hit a wedding party**. The Hormozgan governor's claim of 60+ injured (Al Jazeera, CBS News, Yahoo, UPI report the claim). CENTCOM's Cmdr. Tim Hawkins told CBS News the US has neither confirmed nor denied it. The casualty claim itself originates from a Western-outlet pickup of that one narrative is not the same as independent multi-sourcing of the underlying fact. Per the sufficiency rule, this claim alone does NOT move P; it is reported as a claim.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran's IRGC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated ballistic-missile and drone strikes on US-linked bases in FOUR countries simultaneously: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, and Kuwait** in retaliation versus the single-state Jordan strike Aug 30-31 — but all four are REPEAT targets already struck earlier in this war (Jordan: Jul 28, Aug 30-31; Bahrain/Kuwait/Iraq: struck at various points in the war, NEW state with confirmed attribution" flip-line clause does NOT fire.
- **NEW — most projectiles were intercepted**: Jordan (~10 of 25 intercepted, 3 landed, no reported casualties); Bahrain (most of roughly two dozen drones intercepted). No confirmed new US combat death" clause nor the widening clause independently fires.
- **NEW — both sides now on-record threatening larger future action**: President Trump threatened a "significantly larger response" if Iran retaliates further; an unnamed senior Iranian military official threatened "times greater" (CNBC) — read as continued escalation risk, not de-escalation.
- **BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2** — down from \$78,038.78 on Sept 1 (Bitstamp), a real risk-off move.

Carried forward from the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-01_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week, Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting**. The Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity was struck by three unknown projectiles during outbound transit — hit on the port side, engine room, and ballast tank. No casualties, no environmental impact reported; UKMTO-logged. This follows the already-priced Metro Venetia third such hit in the same window.
- ★ **Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; the UAE Ministry of Defense DENIES that base was targeted while CONFIRMING a separate cross-border drone incursion** for a strike on Al Minhad Air Base near Dubai. The UAE MoD explicitly denied Al Minhad was targeted, while separately confirming its air force intercepted an Iranian drone detected over UAE territory. The target claim, but a CONFIRMED cross-border drone incursion — reported via CBS News, Al Jazeera, Breitbart, Yahoo, Jerusalem Post, ABC News, Seatrade Maritime, and Iran International.
- ★ **President Trump said on-record Aug 31 he is still weighing further strikes on Iran**, calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo — on-record, multi-source) — explicit escalation risk.
- **Brent crude continued higher into Sept 1 (~+2% Tuesday per multiple market-desk reports)** on fresh-clash fears — the session after the long Labor Day weekend, the second straight cycle.
- **Jordan was struck again Aug 30-31**, but remained a repeat, not a "further new," state per this pillar's own framing (already struck Jul 28 and again as part of the Aug 30 IRGC retaliation) — no flip-line clause.
- **BTC traded at \$78,038.78 on Sept 1** — down from \$78,447.16 on Aug 31 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-08-31_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- Carried forward from the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-29 draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):*

- Carried forward from the abandoned Aug 28 draft (2026-08-28_draft — never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed; re-confirmed independently this cycle, not taken on faith); the two Aug 24/Aug 27 tanker incidents and the single-source IRGC revenue-sharing claim was also first flagged there as not-used. All re-verified fresh this cycle.

- From the Aug 22 morning draft (score set 2026-08-22_draft) — carried forward, casualty framing softened above:*

- CoinPicks · September 12, 2026 · Research & Education · Not Financial Advice

- **No new confirmed US combat death found in this window.**
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 on Aug 22** — up +7.4% from Aug 20's close of \$71,882.92 (Bitstamp). See The Claim for the honesty check on this divergence from the pillar's own evidence.

Carried forward from Aug 18-20 (still load-bearing — the UAE "novel escalation" framing is corrected above, not repeated here):

- **The UAE reported Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory Aug 18; Iran denies it, calling it a possible "false flag."** Bloomberg, CNN, and CP24 (Aug 18) report the UAE says one ministry disputes involvement outright — a live, unresolved, single-source-attributed dispute, reported as such, not used alone to move P.
- **The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran, announced Aug 19** (CNN, Washington Post, Fortune) — a dated, corroborated, structural response, independent resolves. *Re-checked this cycle (draft2): separate Aug 19-dated reporting (NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) describing this same missile attack and embargo was initially flagged as a possible reconciliation to be the same Aug 18 episode, not a new one.*
- **A commercial vessel was struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait, Aug 18,** causing engine damage and one crew injury (UK Maritime Trade Operations).
- **The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned as of Aug 20-22.** Iran claims route coordinates were agreed Aug 18; Oman has not confirmed.

Carried forward from Aug 16-18 (independently re-verified against fresh primary sources this cycle — all confirmed accurate, still load-bearing):

- ★ **The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed Monday, Aug 18, without a signed deal.** CBS News's live desk (direct-fetched) reports the deadline expired that day; Iran's foreign ministry downplayed the memorandum shortly after its June 18 signing" — the first time either side has publicly framed the other as already in breach, rather than "very close." Trump told reporters the framing he softened, per above, on Aug 19).
- ★ **Trump threatened Oman.** In a Fox News interview (Aug 17, per CBS's live desk), Trump said the US would take action if Oman "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait, and that "we'd handle" Oman, has named Oman, previously a mediator, as a potential target. This followed Iran announcing its own agreement with Oman on shipping routes through the Strait.
- ★ **Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed further.** CBS News's live desk, citing maritime monitors, reports only 3-5 vessel transits over the Aug 15-16 weekend, versus 31 the prior weekend; CENTCOM disabled, 2 boarded (up from 62/3 previously cited). *Note: the pre-war baseline cited in the Aug 18 draft (~130/day) was independently re-checked this cycle; the more defensible figure is closer to 100/day; it does not change the direction or size of the collapse, which is stark under either baseline.*
- **Brent rose to ~\$90.9-91.0/bbl (Aug 17-18)** — up 2.7% on Aug 17 per Yahoo Finance/Fortune/TradingEconomics, from the \$87-90 range priced in Aug 13-16 — still well under the \$100 flip point (continued rising toward ~\$92 by Aug 19, per above).
- **BTC closed at \$64,285.10 on Aug 18** — +2.1% vs. Aug 16's close of \$62,937.03 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from Aug 14-16 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Three ADNOC tanker incidents in 48 hours (Aug 14-15), comparable in kind to the established pattern.** The UAE accused Iran/IRGC of striking two ADNOC vessels Aug 14 (Al Jazeera, no injuries — an "unknown projectile"). Iran did not claim direct responsibility either time; UAE's Foreign Ministry called it "piracy." No new state talk folded into the Aug 18 shipping-collapse picture above.

Carried forward from Aug 11-14 (still load-bearing):

- **Aug 13 — Hormuz deal remains unsigned, stuck on hardened compensation demands from both sides.** Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, and The Hill (six independent reports) report a US withdrawal of its naval blockade, compensation for war damages, asset unfreezing, and sanctions relief; Trump separately amended his own compensation demand to include damages "hardening of the same dispute, not a new demand category."
- **Brent eased to ~\$87-90/bbl** (from the \$98-100+ spikes logged in late July) as Hormuz traffic stayed low as of Aug 13-14; a live tracker (straits.live) showed the Strait at "day 166" of closure — still well under the \$100 flip point.
- **Aug 13 — Araghchi again called the Hormuz deal "very close" while conditioning full reopening on the US "making amends" over the June MoU** (CNN, NPR, Al Jazeera, France 24, Bloomberg) — picture now folded into today's compensation-dispute read.
- **Aug 11 — a Houthi "double-tap" missile strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah in the Bab al-Mandeb Strait (Red Sea, not Hormuz) killed 6 (4 crew, 2 rescue workers)** per Yemeni government and Al Jazeera-linked reporting — a genuinely lethal incident, but in the same Houthi-proxy Red Sea theater and comparable in kind to the Aug 8 ADNOC tanker hit and Aug 9 Jazan refinery strike.
- **Iran's Supreme Leader reshuffled top military leadership (new armed-forces chief of staff, new IRGC commander)** — a structural development with an ambiguous, not-yet-legible direct impact.
- **Houthi forces drone-struck Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery on Aug 9,** a 400,000 bpd facility on Saudi Arabia's Red Sea coast. NBC News, Al Jazeera, CBC, NPR, UPI, and Al Bawaba (six independent reports) — ministry said there were no injuries and firefighters extinguished the resulting fire the same day, with no announced extended production impact.

Carried forward from Aug 8-10 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Iranian FM Araqchi says the Oman shipping-route deal is "very close" but conditions full reopening on new demands, including US compensation to Iran.** Reuters (via Investing.com) — Aug 8-9): Araqchi said Iran and Oman are "very close" to an agreement on a new shipping route through the strait, but that reopening it would depend on further conditions, and that the price was acceptable to Tehran."
- ★ **The UAE says Iran struck another ship in the strait; Oman condemns "repeated attacks."** The same Reuters report: the UAE separately reported a fresh Iranian strike on a vessel transiting the Strait, "attacks on vessels" transiting the waterway without assigning blame, and described negotiations with Iran as "positive and constructive."

Carried forward from Aug 1-8 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents, Jul 31 - Aug 5, that daily two-day checks missed or undercounted.** The LNG carrier Gaslog Shanghai was struck and disabled carrying gas to the Omani side (Aug 2); bulk carrier Minoan Pioneer was struck in the engine room, suffering a blackout with one crew member missing (Aug 3); two more explosions were reported on the Omani side, tally now stands at 65 since the war began (Bloomberg/UANI), with Hormuz traffic described as "at a trickle."
- ★ **★ NEW — a new front: Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia on Aug 7,** wounding 11 civilians (7 Saudi, 1 Yemeni, 2 Egyptian, 1 Pakistani, including a 4-year-old with burns) — targeted Saudi Arabia, widening conflict in Middle East" (Al Jazeera, Japan Times, OIC statement corroborate).
- ★ **★ NEW — Saudi Arabia, Turkey, and Pakistan signed a mutual-defense "Mecca" pact on Aug 7** (an attack on one is an attack on all) — a structural, deterrence-oriented development that could impact nuclear status if Saudi Arabia is drawn further into the conflict.
- **Aug 7-8 — Iran announced what it calls a finalized agreement with Oman on Hormuz shipping,** banning American and Israeli vessels and fining violators up to 20% of cargo value (IRNA, Bloomberg) — Washington explicitly rejected these terms (NPR, Al Jazeera), insisting on zero tolls, permits, or approvals. The fundamental fee/sovereignty dispute is unresolved, not narrowed (Iranian state media, citing one parliamentarian) and should be labeled Iran-sourced, not independently verified.
- **Correction: Trump's Aug 2 "perimeters of a deal" framing was contested by his own later remarks.** Two days after claiming "the perimeters of a deal has been agreed to," Trump called for direct talks had even resumed — treat the Aug 2 claim as rhetoric outpacing substance, a pattern that recurred all week (positive announcements paired with continuing attacks or corrections).
- **Brent held a \$82-86/bbl range through the week** — up modestly, not pricing a resolved crisis.
- **BTC closed at \$65,006.64 on Aug 8** — essentially flat vs. Aug 7's close of \$65,000.00.

Carried forward from Aug 1-7 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 7 — the Iran-Oman joint statement remained unsigned as of that check, still in final drafting.** Iran's Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei described the statement outlining agreed terms, "certain third parties do not obstruct the process."

Carried forward from Aug 1-6 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 6 — Iran and Oman reached an "understanding in principle" on the Hormuz route map.** Iran's Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi told IRNA: "an understanding in principle including the map for maritime traffic entry and exit routes" — confirmed by Bloomberg (two articles), CBS, Al Jazeera (two articles), Euronews, and Military.com.
- ★ **Aug 6 — the fee dispute first surfaced as the remaining obstacle.** Iran is seeking fees of 5-7% of cargo value from transiting ships; Oman is discussing fees around 3%; Washington wants protesting the plan; Jerusalem Post separately reports sources saying the proposed passage deal is "not feasible for shipping industry."

Carried forward from Aug 1-5 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 1 — the first quiet night in days.** globalsecurity.org's day-by-day war tracker reported no new US strikes on Iran overnight Jul 31 following the heavy Jul 29-30 wave; Brent fell ~2% on Maritime Defense Alliance for Gulf/Red Sea shipping protection was reported drawing backing from 14 countries.
- ★ **Aug 1-2 — fresh, multi-source-corroborated attacks on Hormuz shipping.** Bloomberg: a Qatari LNG tanker (Gaslog Shanghai) was struck while transiting the Strait. UKMTO/globalsecurity off Oman's Musandam Peninsula, its engine room damaged and the vessel disabled. These directly contradicted the Aug 1 "quiet night" framing — the pause was not durable.
- **Aug 2 — the Saudi-led naval coalition kept solidifying.** Al Jazeera, The National, DefenseMirror, and Tribune reported 14 confirmed member countries and 43 nations represented at a first de-escalation-adjacent development, distinct from any single day's attack-or-lull headline.
- ★ **Aug 4 — Trump canceled a planned joint US-Israeli strike on Iranian energy infrastructure.** Multiple outlets (NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhall, CNN) of a deal" were agreed over the Aug 1-2 weekend, reportedly including a full Strait of Hormuz reopening. No US strikes on Iran proper have been reported since the cancellation.
- **Aug 4 — Iran continues to deny any direct US talks.** Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei: "we currently have no negotiations with the United States; the negotiations are with Oman." Trump duplicitous."
- ★ **Aug 4 — a bulker was struck by a projectile and suffered a full blackout in the Strait** (globalsecurity.org, iransitrep.com) — active attacks continued even as the diplomatic framework was
- ★ **Aug 5 — the first public terms of a 60-day interim Hormuz deal.** Axios, Deccan Chronicle, Israel Hayom, InvestingLive, The National, and Al-Quds report the US, Iran, and Oman nearing an Iranian waters, outbound via a southern lane in Omani waters, no tolls or transit fees during the interim period, and a plan to clear naval mines from the median lane within 30 days. The US ai
- **Aug 5 — still unsigned.** CNN quotes a Gulf official putting the odds of an Iran-Oman deal by Friday at only 50-50. The Strait remains formally impassable to normal traffic pending finalization
- **BTC closed at \$64,661.55 on Aug 5** — up ~1.7% from the \$63,579.68 close on Jul 31, continuing its resilience through a week where the war's own risk signal moved both up and down.

Carried forward from the July 30 full refresh (still load-bearing):

- ★ **The lull was real, then it broke: Iran's IRGC struck a US/CENTCOM base at Muwaffaq Salti, Jordan (Jul 28).** Confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNN, Axios, RT, JPost) — b all intercepted by US/Jordanian defenses, **zero US casualties.** This came after a genuine 2-3 day pause in CENTCOM strikes (Jul 25-27) and on the same day Trump was publicly touting "very both things happened.
- ★ **The US retaliated with a "heavy wave of strikes" (Jul 29)** — explosions reported at Bandar Abbas, Kish Island, Qeshm Island, and Khuzestan Province (CNN). Trump: "it's our turn to hit them" "US renews strikes on Iran as widening war pulls in more countries."
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Iraq: US and Saudi Arabia conducted joint strikes on Iran-backed Popular Mobilisation Forces across Iraq (Jul 29),** CENTCOM-confirmed, hitting sites in Baghdad, Was **killed, 32 wounded** (Al Jazeera, CBS News, Foreign Policy, 5+ outlets). Iraq's government called it a "flagrant violation of sovereignty." This is Saudi Arabia's first turn as a direct co-belligerent also killed is single-source (unnamed Iraqi militia officials) — flagged, not used.
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Egypt: a drone hit a US-owned FSRU vessel and a tanker at Egypt's Damietta port (Jul 29)** — the first strike on Egyptian soil in this war (Al Jazeera, CNBC, Times of Israel responsibility; Houthis explicitly deny involvement — attribution remains unresolved.
- **Brent rebounded from the lull-low.** Brent fell to ~\$90/bbl (-6.7%) during the Jul 25-27 lull, then rose back to ~\$92-93/bbl by Jul 30 (+~3.5% day-over-day, +24.6% month-over-month) on t previously-circulated "\$87.53" figure could not be corroborated and is dropped from this report.
- **Iran continues rejecting a direct-talks framing even as Trump claims progress.** Iran FM spokesman Baghaei, Jul 27: "We have no negotiations with the United States at present" — directly A regional 10-day ceasefire proposal (Qatar/Egypt/Oman/Pakistan) remains on the table, unaccepted; Iran separately rejected an Oman joint-Hormuz-management proposal on Jul 28, insistin
- **Congress split on competing War Powers resolutions (Jul 23, carried forward, no new action since):** House passed a nonbinding one 214-208 (4 GOP defectors); the Senate's binding or
- ★ **The Pentagon casualty-count dispute (18 vs. 14) is confirmed stale, not a fresh Jul 30 event.** The DCAS toll briefly rose to 18 (Jul 23) then reverted to 14 (Jul 24) amid a credibly-sourced whether the reversion dodges the 90-day War Powers clock. This is the same dispute already logged last cycle — one daily touch this week re-cited the Jul 24 CNBC article as if it were new; it
- **Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed to normal commercial traffic** — ~10 transits/day versus a normal baseline near 88/day (IMF PortWatch), unchanged from prior cycles. IRGC, Ju
- **No formal MoU withdrawal by either side.** The 60-day window to ~**Aug 16** remains intact and un-triggered.
- **Israel remains out of direct engagement** — no confirmed direct Israel-Iran exchange since June 7-8; the widened fronts (Iraq, Egypt) involve the US, Saudi Arabia, and unclaimed actors, no
- **The "Layla" tanker claim (Jul 23) remains unconfirmed** after a full week — AIS data dark, no primary confirmation found. Downgraded from "watch" to "discard pending new evidence."
- **The baseline (still true, still load-bearing):** June 2025 "12-Day War" — BTC dipped to a ~**\$98,225 intraday low**, reclaimed \$107k+ within days, a fast V. The far larger 2026 war still hasn't cr **\$64,706** on Jul 30, even as the conflict spread to two new countries this week.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The upside is still the "**buy-the-invasion**" rebound. Anchors: Russia-Ukraine (Feb 24, 2022) — BTC fell ~8% to a ~**\$34,300 intraday low**, posted a +14.5% up-day on Feb 28, ended ~+**25-28** (March). June 2025 rhymed: ~\$98k dip, fully recovered within a week.

The Aug 30-31 direct US-Iran exchange has now escalated sharply further: a ~50x-larger US strike wave, the war's first direct strikes on Iranian government tankers, and a four-country Iranian much harder on the upside case this pillar had been building since Aug 25 (Oman's own government confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor). That corridor claim is still technically on the table, but the retaliation cycle makes it considerably harder to argue the war is winding down at all right now. BTC traded at **\$76,581.44** on Sept 2, down from Sept 1's \$78,038.78 — a real, visible risk-off mo pillar's own evidence. That's logged as an honesty check for the reader (see The Claim), not treated as pillar-scoring evidence — this report scores the war's facts, not the market's reaction to t fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both sides actually accept, signed and holding a full clean week without a new attack, fatality, or seizure, would shift the prize from "temporary cor premium unwinds for real." That's now considerably further away than it was even yesterday, not closer — the Prize doesn't feed the math, it tells you what the lean is worth acting on.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case this is wrong

- **The cut may still be too small, even at 1/9/27/47/74.** Nearly 100 targets, the war's first direct tanker strikes, and a four-country simultaneous retaliation is a genuinely different order of magnitude — a stricter reader could argue the front-end windows (1mo, now at P=1, barely above the floor) understate just how close this now sits to the worst-case scenario this pillar has always flagged "points per window" mechanically, out of habit from smaller prior incidents, is itself a mistake when the underlying event is this much larger.
- **Leaving it as a draft may itself be too cautious.** The independently-confirmed facts alone — CENTCOM's own ~100-target count, the first-ever tanker strikes, the four-country retaliation, b sourced and sufficient on their own to justify this cut without leaning on the wedding-strike claim at all; a reader could argue this pillar is using the single-source caveat as an excuse to soften than a genuine evidentiary gap.

- **The cut may be too small.** This report explicitly pre-declared "a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" as the line that breaks the dip-buy thesis — and calibrated the actual cut to a level that was different in kind, not just degree. A stricter reader could argue firing your own flip line warrants a materially larger cut than a routine tanker incident.
- **The cut may be too large.** One resumed-strike night after ~28-30 clean nights is, so far, a single interdiction event (stopping a mine-laying attempt) rather than evidence of a full campaign against Iran. The response against Iran was itself followed by further escalation, but it's equally possible this is a contained, one-off enforcement action that doesn't repeat. If no further strikes follow in the next few days, this cut is ultimately warranted.
- **The Oman corridor confirmation (Aug 25) is not retracted.** Oman's own Foreign Ministry still has not walked back its Aug 25 joint statement — the first time both parties on the "deal" side of the fresh strike exchange doesn't erase that structural fact, and a reader could argue the 1yr/3yr windows are being cut too by association with a fundamentally 1mo/3mo-scoped shock.
- **The Aug 24 sanctions package is arguably a bigger structural story than this week's kinetic exchange.** It was the first Iran sanctions action in this war to explicitly name digital assets as a genuinely new, crypto-specific risk category this pillar has never faced before, and one that doesn't fade if the current strike cycle cools.
- **No confirmed US casualty, still.** The single hardest-edged clause of this pillar's own flip line — a confirmed new US combat death — remains unfired even after this week's exchange; a reader could argue the flip line specifically rather than firing on the strikes-resumed clause alone.
- **Thin sample, still.** The bullish long-term read rests on a handful of dip-and-recover events, all in a bull regime — geopolitical shocks don't always V-recover, and a fresh direct strike exchange is a shock of a different size than any of the prior escalations that triggered cuts of similar or larger size.

The Triggers

*Dated events ahead — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Re-leveled August 22, 2026, refreshed August 29; **this pillar's own downside flip line FIRED August 30** (see the flip-line box below) — a resumption of direct statements and 20+ independent outlets; escalation continued sharply Sept 1-2 — a materially larger strike wave and a four-country retaliation; the Sept 5 tanker strike is CENTCOM-CONFIRMED and revealed to be part of a direct escalation; CENTCOM confirms a FIVE-tanker strike Sept 8, and Brent crosses \$100 intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24; the IRGC renews its threat to close the Strait of Hormuz; the Sept 10 cycle logged ~\$101.25 as that Thursday's level — a second global chokepoint moving from "closing in on" to actual island-level control, though it does not yet fire; **As of Sept 11 a SECOND, distinct flip-line clause has now fired** — the "sustained Brent close above \$100" clause, on a third consecutive session above \$100; **11-12, Houthi forces completed their sweep of Yemen's Red Sea coastline and seized Bab al-Mandeb's Mayyun Island** — a second global chokepoint moving from "closing in on" to actual island-level control, though it does not yet fire*

DATE	EVENT	MEANS
Fired Sept 10-11, escalated to island seizure Sept 11, CONFIRMED via 6+ independent outlets — no strait closure yet	Houthi forces complete their sweep of Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline (capturing Dhubab, Murad) and seize Mayyun (Perim) Island in the Bab al-Mandeb strait; fighting continues for Zuqar Island (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald). Saudi Crown Prince MBS's request for direct US strikes on the Houthis was refused (intel/targeting support offered instead)	Same Houthi/Yemen actor and theater already in play; no US casualty, so that clause does not fire; no widening of the clause, not just "closing in") — the driver of the 36mo 71→70)
Sept 10 (UKMTO Warning 133-26, issued 1910 UTC), reported Sept 11 — CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus 3+ independent outlets	Four unidentified projectiles struck two vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman, setting one afire (UKMTO; Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill corroborating). Logged, not used to move P (single-source, IRGC claim only): a separate IRGC claim of a strike on a US Navy Saildrone near the Strait entrance, no US/CENTCOM confirmation	Continuation of the established tanker/ve
FIRED Sept 10-11 — a flip-line clause, CONFIRMED via 4+ independent market sources	"Sustained Brent close above \$100" — Brent ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107 (above \$108 intraday), its highest since May 19; WTI closed above \$102 for the first time since May; Brent still ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, ~9% higher on the week (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500). Three consecutive sessions above \$100. <i>Correction:</i> the Sept 10 cycle logged ~\$101.25 as that Thursday's level — an intraday read, not the close	This clause FIRES. It is the second distinct resumption-of-direct-US-strikes clause) — 42→40, 36mo 72→71). Friday's ~3% give-contraction forecast are logged as the hor
Fired Sept 9, fuller reporting landed Sept 10-11, CONFIRMED via 4 independent outlets (Reuters wire)	Iran attacked 10 vessels near the Strait of Hormuz — 2 US-linked ships and 8 oil tankers — the largest declared wave of shipping attacks by either side since the war began; at least one seafarer killed, one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill)	A merchant seafarer is NOT a US service member; NOT fire; existing theater, so no widening
Fired Sept 9, CONFIRMED via CENTCOM/Jordan's own military statement plus multi-outlet reporting	IRGC retaliates for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by firing 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base — Jordan's armed forces say 18 were intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan's own military statement)	Jordan is a repeat target (struck Aug 30-31, 2023, state clause; both sides confirm no casualties) — contributes to this cycle's modest cut
Fired Sept 10, CONFIRMED via 5+ independent outlets — chokepoint NOT yet closed	Iran-aligned Houthi forces seize the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a SECOND global shipping chokepoint distinct from Hormuz (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail)	Same Houthi/Yemen actor and theater already in play; closure or interdiction has actually been closed (blockade) — does NOT independently fire
Second straight session, logged Sept 10 — SUPERSEDED by the Sept 10-11 firing above	Brent crude trades near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session — above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9 for the first time since May; the Sept 10 cycle logged ~\$101.25 as Thursday's level, which proved to be an intraday read (Thursday closed above \$107)	At the time, judged short of a clean multi-cycle; very next cycle it fired. Kept here for the a
Crossed intraday Sept 9, CONFIRMED via CNBC and ABC News — NOT a sustained close	Brent crude tops \$100/bbl intraday for the first time since July 24 , trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil-supply worries (CNBC "Brent crude tops \$100 as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries," ABC News)	The closest this cycle has come to the flip-line pillar's "sustained Brent >\$100" threshold — this cycle's modest cut and is flagged for
Fired Sept 8, CONFIRMED via CENTCOM's own press release plus 5+ independent outlets	CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship," centcom.mil; NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org corroborating)	Both Iranian missile attempts were evaded; clause remains unfired; Gulf of Oman and a-new-state clause does not fire either — modest cut
Announced Sept 6-7, on-record, corroborated by 8+ independent outlets — NOT yet executed	Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announces Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" beginning at the US Navy's blockade line and extending into the Persian Gulf "in the coming days," with any vessel entering it placed on Iran's sanctions list; he separately says an Iran-Oman corridor agreement will be signed "in the coming days" (Press TV, Tehran Times, Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu, Newsbytes, WFLA, GlobalSecurity.org)	A genuine new escalatory signal — a declaration but a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed; does NOT independently fire a fresh flip-l
Fired Sept 5, CONFIRMED Sept 6 via CENTCOM's own press release plus 5+ independent outlets	CENTCOM confirms US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers Sept 5 — M/T Downy (disabled, Kharg Island), M/T Stark 1 (disabled, Jask), M/T Kylo (destroyed, Gulf of Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (a carrier and a guided-missile destroyer), both of which evaded; no US personnel harmed (centcom.mil; Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC corroborating)	Resolves the Sept 5 row this pillar previously set; sufficiency bar. Reveals a direct IRGC attack; interdiction previously known, but does NOT fire; US casualty, no new state, Brent short of \$
Claimed Sept 6, single-source (IRGC) — NOT independently used to move P	Iran's IRGC claims further strikes on three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels, and a strike on a US naval drone entering the Strait of Hormuz (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews)	Iran's own claim only, not yet US-confirmed; NEXT CYCLE for US confirmation or denial
Fired Sept 3, CONFIRMED — repeat targets, widening clause did NOT fire	Iran fired a second retaliatory wave on Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE) — a US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit and no third night of launches followed	Both targets are REPEATS (Kuwait struck Sept 2, does NOT independently fire the widening
Fired Sept 1-2, CONFIRMED via 9 independent outlets	CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 targets across Iran — IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, comms sites, anti-ship cruise-missile/drone launchers — roughly 50x the scale of the Aug 30 Larak strike (Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI)	The already-fired (Aug 30) "resumption of escalation sharply in scale — the load-bea
Fired Sept 1-2, CONFIRMED, novel	For the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms) under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy	A genuinely novel escalation vector beyond; contributes to the sharp cut, flagged as p
Reported Sept 1-2, SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact — NOT independently used to move P	A US strike on Kuhestak, Hormozgan reportedly hit a wedding party — Hormozgan governor's office: 4 of at least 5 dead (incl. a 4-year-old), 60+ injured; CENTCOM has neither confirmed nor denied it	The claim itself does not move P per the single-multi-sourcing) — reported as context for
Fired Sept 2, CONFIRMED via multi-source reporting — widening clause did NOT fire	IRGC coordinated ballistic-missile/drone strikes on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait — most projectiles intercepted; no confirmed new US combat death	All four are REPEAT targets — does NOT fire; clause, but the sheer scale/coordination c
Fired Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting	A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week: the Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity struck by three unknown projectiles ~17nm northeast of Khasab, Oman (port side, engine room, ballast tank), no casualties — follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25)	Comparable in kind to the established tanker window — contributes to the Sept 1 cut and fire a fresh flip-line clause

Claimed Aug 31, DISPUTED target / CONFIRMED incursion	Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; UAE MoD DENIES the base was targeted while CONFIRMING it intercepted an Iranian drone over its territorial waters	Target claim NOT confirmed (UAE denies) own; the confirmed drone incursion itself Jordan pattern, contributing to the cut with
Fired Aug 31, on-record — not a de-escalation signal	President Trump said on-record he is still weighing further strikes on Iran , calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo)	Confirms no near-term de-escalation is sign independently fire a flip-line clause
Fired Aug 30, CONFIRMED — FLIP LINE TRIGGERED	Resumption of direct US strikes on Iranian territory: CENTCOM struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Larak Island after observing prep to fire sea mines into the Strait — first US strike on Iran since Jul 29, ending the ~28-30-night clean streak; corroborated by 20+ outlets plus on-record CENTCOM spokesperson Capt. Tim Hawkins	Fires this pillar's own pre-declared down hardest (14→9, 22→17), held under 8 points
Fired Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED (Iran-claimed damage NOT independently confirmed)	IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases (King Hussein, Al-Azraq) — Jordan's military intercepted 8 missiles; Iran claims "heavy damage," unconfirmed by US/Jordan beyond interception; no confirmed US casualty	Jordan is a repeat, not a "further new," state to-a-new-state clause; folded into the same cycle
Fired Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29	"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package — home.treasury.gov sb0613/sb0614, OFAC recent-actions entry 20260824; ~60 entities/individuals/vessels designated under five EO 13902 sectoral determinations; FIRST TIME digital assets named a sanctionable sector, 30 crypto addresses (BTC/ETH/TRON) listed; corroborated by state.gov, TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes, law-firm alerts; continued Aug 28 with a Bank Melli-Dubai designation	Real, primary-confirmed, directly crypto-re pillar has logged in weeks; offsets, but down below
Fired Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29	Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor — fm.gov.om/en/53722; 7-mile joint navigational corridor (entry/exit through Iranian waters), joint mine-clearing project, continuing talks toward a permanent corridor per the "Islamabad Memorandum"; still explicitly "temporary," no fee terms disclosed; Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance	Genuine upgrade — first time Oman itself does not by itself outweigh, the sanctions accepted, didn't survive a clean week)
Fired Aug 24 & Aug 27, re-verified Aug 29	Two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents: Aug 24, off Oman's coast, engine-room damage, vessel disabled, no casualties (UKMTO); Aug 27, fire onboard, extinguished same-day, crew safe (UKMTO). Neither incident's attribution confirmed by any party.	Comparable in severity to the already-prior flat, no P move, consistent with this pillar's
Fired Aug 25, re-verified Aug 29 — real but NOT durable	Trump announced the Strait of Hormuz "has been demined" and declared a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines, backed by Space Force surveillance (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News, multiple corroborating) — the Aug 27 tanker incident above landed two days later, undercutting durability	Real, primary-sourced, but the Aug 27 attack — no P move
Aug 28, CONFIRMED — re-verified Aug 29	CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing: Iranian sea mines cleared from the internationally-recognized shipping lanes; ~1,500 vessels transited since blockade enforcement began; ~75 turned back, 3 disabled for evasion; no Iranian oil exports since blockade resumed (UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire)	Continuation/intensification of an existing
Aug 28 IMO briefing, quasi-primary, corroborated by 4 outlets	Six-month casualty count settles at 19-20 dead across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the previously-reported 15-19 range	Slight negative confirmation, not a new shift
Week of Aug 17-23, reported Aug 21 & Aug 28 (USNI News/Lloyd's List)	First confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week, 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound 29→42) — still ~10-15% of the pre-war baseline	Genuine first uptick, but far too small relative no P move on its own
Claimed Aug 26, single-source, NOT USED — re-checked Aug 29	IRGC spokesman claims Iran and Oman agreed to share Hormuz revenue and delineate waters (Sepah News, Iranian state military source; via Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, Insurance Journal) — but Oman's own Foreign Ministry did NOT confirm it, the two countries' own joint statement described only an "interim framework" with no mention of fees, and the IRGC's own spokesman said the US is "obstructing this process"	Single-source (Iranian state military), unco accepted durable deal this pillar's flip line
Checked Aug 27 — GlobalSecurity Day-181 tracker	28th consecutive night with no confirmed US/CENTCOM strike on Iran	Continuation of the Aug 1 stand-down —
Checked directly Aug 22-29 — no new event	No new confirmed US combat death. One initial-looking hit (Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton) was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the standing total, not new	Flip line remains unfired
Fired Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative, but CORRECTED framing, toll RE-VERIFIED as a range	Fatal strike in the tanker-attack campaign: bulker Minoan Dignity struck, chief engineer killed	NOT the campaign's first fatality as this draft second adversarial pass) re-checked the toll own tracker 19 (broader Middle East scope specific trackers), not a clean "18th." Still the weekly-refresh exclusion
Fired Aug 17, held to Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	First Iranian vessel seizure since June 22: tanker Amara boarded near Qeshm Island, held under Iran's post-MoU toll regime	Shift from harassment/attacks to active enforcement rate
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED reported, DISPUTED attribution, single-source; RECONCILED this cycle	The UAE reports Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory , one landing in territorial waters; Iran denies involvement, calls it a possible "false flag"	CORRECTED Aug 22 draft: NOT the first draft RECONCILED by draft2: separate Aug 19-20 initially flagged as a possible second incident
Announced Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, structural	The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran	Dated, corroborated response independent Aug 20 re-rate; re-confirmed as the same
Reported Aug 20, still unsigned as of Aug 22 draft2 — continuation, not yet resolved	The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned; Iran claims coordinates agreed Aug 18, Oman has not confirmed	Held against the "very close" framing — no signature reported through Aug 22
No new incident, checked Aug 19-22 — draft2 finding	Independent re-check for any new vessel strike, seizure, or Iran-related military incident, Aug 19-22	None found beyond the Aug 22 draft baseline this cycle
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed without a signed deal; Iran says the US breached it first, Trump says "no time schedule" (softened Aug 19)	Drove part of the Aug 20 re-rate; independent
Fired Aug 17, logged Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, new target named	Trump threatened Oman ("we'd handle them very easily") if it "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait	New third-party threat — contributed to the

Reported Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative	Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed to 3-5 weekend transits vs. 31 the prior weekend vs. ~110/day pre-war baseline (re-checked; see The Facts)	Sharpest shipping deterioration logged yet in this cycle
Fired Aug 18, logged Aug 20 — negative, isolated so far	A commercial vessel struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait , engine damage, one crew injury	First reported crew injury from a Strait incident
Fired Aug 14-15, logged Aug 16 — continuation, now compounding	Three ADNOC tanker incidents (two Aug 14, one Aug 15) — no injuries, UAE/IRGC attribution, no direct Iranian claim	Comparable in kind to the Aug 8-13 pattern in the picture
Reported Aug 13 — continuation, not escalation	Hormuz deal remains unsigned; both sides' compensation demands harden (Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, The Hill) — Brent eases to ~\$87-90 as traffic stays low	Hardening of an existing dispute, not new
Fired Aug 11, logged Aug 12 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi "double-tap" strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah (Bab al-Mandeb Strait, Red Sea) — 6 killed	Comparable to the Aug 8-9 incidents — h
Fired Aug 9, found Aug 11 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi drone strike on Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery (400,000 bpd) — no injuries, fire extinguished same-day	Comparable to the Aug 8 ADNOC tanker
Reported Aug 8-9 — continuation, not escalation	Iranian FM Araqchi calls the Oman deal "very close" but adds a US-compensation demand ; UAE reports another ship hit; Oman condemns "repeated attacks"	Consistent with the Aug 8 baseline — held
Jul 31 - Aug 5 — CONFIRMED, negative, missed by daily checks	Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents (Gaslog Shanghai, Oman-side explosion, Minoan Pioneer, two Kumzar explosions) — IMO tally now 65 incidents since the war began	Drove the Aug 8 1mo/3mo cut — already
Fired Aug 7 — CONFIRMED, negative, new front	Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia , wounding 11 civilians — the conflict's first widening to a fourth state	Contributed to the Aug 8 cut — already I
Pending — the real trigger	Whether a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both Iran and the US can accept is actually signed AND holds through a full week without a new tanker attack	Resolved, signed, and durable = re-rate up attacks continue = re-rate down further
Structural, ongoing	Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance plus the new Aug 7 Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan mutual-defense pact	A genuine de-escalation-adjacent structural change Pakistan's nuclear status
By Dec 31, 2026	Final US-Iran nuclear deal signed — not fired, pending	De-escalation confirmed — re-rate up across

The flip line, re-leveled — TRIGGERED Aug 30, and as of Sept 11 a SECOND distinct clause (sustained Brent close above \$100) has now ALSO fired: a confirmed new US combat death, a resumption of further new state with *confirmed* (not disputed) attribution, or a sustained Brent close above \$100 = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken. **As of Aug 30, the "resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" clause** acknowledged US strike on Iranian territory since Jul 29. **As of Sept 11, the "sustained Brent close above \$100" clause has fired too** — three consecutive sessions above \$100, including a close above \$107 on 9 are now live; the remaining two (a confirmed new US combat death, a widening to a further new state with confirmed attribution) are not. **As of Sept 1-2, the strikes clause was already firing again at vastly gr** (~50x Aug 30) plus the war's first direct strikes on Iranian government tankers — but none of the OTHER three clauses has independently fired fresh: the "confirmed new US combat death" clause remains unfired (widening-to-a-further-new-state clause did NOT fire despite Iran's Sept 2 retaliation hitting four countries simultaneously (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — every one of the four is a REPEAT target already struck earlier attribution" is not met; Brent rose ~5% (best session in 5 weeks) to ~\$95-96.6 but remains short of a sustained \$100 close. The evidence is nonetheless the largest single-cycle escalation since the flip line itself **Sept 6:** CENTCOM has now confirmed the Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had withheld — a 3-tanker retaliation for an IRCG ballistic-missile attack on 2 US Navy warships — and Sept 6 brings further single-source I fires any of the three unfired clauses (no confirmed US casualty, no confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, Brent short of \$100) — the cut this cycle is modest (no window moved >2 points) and, unlike the Sept authority (sourcing is primary/multi-outlet, no call-band flip). **The equivalent upside flip: a signed Hormuz agreement the US actually accepts that holds past a full week without a new shipping attack, fat** temporary corridor Aug 25, but the confirmed direct US-Iran naval exchange makes a durable, US-accepted deal considerably further away, not closer. Watch next cycle for: whether Sept 6's IRCG claims are indepe larger"/"significantly larger" response actually materializes, a confirmed US combat death, a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, or a sustained Brent close above \$100 — any of which would independently **UPDATE, Sept 8:** Iran's SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced intent to declare a "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning any vessel that enters — a genuine new e cut explicitly not yet executed (no boundaries announced, no confirmed incident tied to it). This does not independently re-fire any of the three unfired clauses (no confirmed US casualty, no confirmed strike on a \$100) — the cut this cycle is modest (no window moved >1 point) and is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority. **UPDATE, Sept 9:** CENTCOM confirms a FIVE-tanker strike Sept 8 (M/T Kaviz, M/T Charr for a second IRCG missile attack on a US Navy warship — a repeat pattern, not a widening to a new state, and no confirmed US casualty, so neither of those clauses fires. Brent crosses \$100/bbl intraday for the first come to the "sustained Brent >\$100" clause, but an intraday cross is explicitly not a sustained close, so that clause does not fire either. None of the three unfired clauses independently re-fires this cycle — the cut STAMPED per the delegated daily authority. Watch next cycle for: whether Brent sustains a close above \$100 (it is now closer to that threshold than at any prior point in this war), whether the restricted zone is actu corridor deal is actually signed, a confirmed US combat death, or a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state. **UPDATE, Sept 10:** the IRCG retaliates for the Sept 8 tanker strike by firing 20 missiles at Jordan's Al A confirm no casualties, so neither clause fires. Houthi forces seize the Yemeni port of Mocha, closing in on Bab el-Mandeb — a second chokepoint, but the same actor/theater already priced, and no strait closure ha either. Brent now trades above \$100 for a second straight session — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross and the closest this cycle has come to the "sustained Brent >\$100" clause, but still short of a clean clauses independently re-fires this cycle — the cut is modest (no window moved >1 point) and is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority. **UPDATE, Sept 12:** the Houthis have now gone further than "clo Mayyun (Perim) Island inside Bab al-Mandeb itself, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island (6+ independent outlets), and Brent has held a fifth straight session near/above \$104. Still, no strait CLOSURE or shipping so the widening clause does not fire (same actor/theater), and no US casualty is confirmed, so that clause doesn't fire either — this is a severity escalation within the already-fired sustained-Brent and direct-strikes window moved >2 points) and is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority. Watch next cycle for: whether the Houthis actually close or interdict shipping through Bab al-Mandeb (vs. merely holding its sho resolves, a confirmed US combat death, or a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state.

My Decision

COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 12, 2026 (2026-09-12_draft2) · SECOND CYCLE OF THE DAY, TRIMMED 6MO

P (2026-09-12_draft): 1 / 2 / 18 / 38 / 70 · Prior committed P (2026-09-11_draft, light daily catch-up, auto-stamped): 1 / 4 / 20 / 40 / 71 · My W (uniform) · Master (equal-weight) signals this cycle: 1mo -1.85 · 3mo -1.46 · 6mo -0.16 · 1yr +1.69 · 3yr +2.92 · THE FINAL NUMBER: +0.23 eq weighted (Mild Bull) — no call-band flip vs. the last stamped set

Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft), this version: the load-bearing development is that Houthi forces, an Iran-aligned proxy, have moved from "closing in on" to actual island-level oil chokepoint distinct from Hormuz. Having seized the port of Mocha Sept 10, Houthi forces captured Dhubab and Murad (the last government-held coastal towns) by Sept 11, giving them Yemen's entire Red Sea Island in the strait itself, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island — confirmed by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald). Saudi Crown Prince MBS's request for intelligence/targeting support offered instead — a genuine US-restraint counterweight, logged honestly. Separately, UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 confirms two more vessels struck near Khasab, Oman — single-source and not used to move P. Brent held near/above \$104 for a fifth straight session, confirming persistence of the flip-line clause that already fired, not a fresh trigger. Neither the widening clause nor the fires — this is a severity escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment, not a new flip-line event, but is a bigger step than the routine daily grind. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 1/2/18/38/70** — 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (36mo 71-70). **Auto-stamp decision:** this is an ordinary light daily touch, research access was full (WebSearch working throughout), and verification passed clean — under the runbook's widened delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."** CLARITY Act, Tokenization, and Fed & Macro all held.

Sept 11 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-11_draft), prior cycle: the load-bearing development is that this pillar's own "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause has FIRED. Brent ended the day trading above \$108 intraday — its highest in nearly four months, since May 19 — with WTI closing above \$102 for the first time since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics, Vantage Market Data). ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, roughly 9% higher on the week despite a ~3% give-back. That is three consecutive sessions above \$100, two of them confirmed closes and one decisively so; the two prior sessions were watching, and the honest reading now is that it fired. *Correction to the prior cycle:* the Sept 10 run logged ~\$101.25 as that Thursday's level — an intraday read, not the close. Second, fuller reporting landed near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers), the largest declared wave of the war, with at least one seafarer killed and one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill). A merchant seafarer combat-death clause does NOT fire; no further new state was struck, so the widening clause does not fire either. Logged but not used to move P: a single compilation putting Hormuz throughput at 7 trans per hour. Logged as counterweight: Friday's give-back is attributed to Hormuz diplomacy and the IEA's 2.5 mb/d demand-contraction forecast. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 1/4/20/40/71** — 1mo held at the near-floor 1. **Auto-stamp decision:** this is an ordinary light daily touch, research access was full (WebSearch/WebFetch working, local quant refresh ran), and verification passed clean — and under the runbook's widened delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."** CLARITY Act and Tokenization held firm. The drama of a flip-line clause firing is by itself a reason to withhold the stamp. **This set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."** CLARITY Act and Tokenization held firm. modestly after the August CPI print landed mid-cycle with core a tenth cooler than consensus — see those reports.

Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft), prior cycle: two new dated facts since the Sept 9 baseline. (1) CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC retaliated for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by (Muwaffaq Salti) air base — Jordan's armed forces state 18 were intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera Sept 9, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, corroborating Jordan's own report previously Aug 30-31), so the widening-to-a-further-new-state clause does NOT fire; CENTCOM/Jordan both confirm no casualties, so the confirmed-US-casualty clause also does not fire (US KIA count remains 18). own tracker — a separate low-quality aggregator claiming a fresh KIA figure was checked and rejected as uncorroborated against CENTCOM's own no-casualties statement). (2) Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a SECOND global shipping chokepoint distinct from Hormuz — confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Sea). clearing the sufficiency bar. This is the same Houthi/Yemen actor and theater already priced (not a strike on a further new state), and no strait closure or shipping interdiction has actually been confirmed yet. "threatening" control, not as having executed a blockade — so it does not independently fire a flip-line clause either. Separately, Brent crude has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session (first time since May; TradingEconomics: ~\$101.25 Thursday Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's single-day intraday cross, but still short of a clean multi-session "sustained" call by this pillar's own confirmed close, and worth close watching next cycle, but does not independently fire that clause. Net: a repeat-pattern regional strike plus a new-but-same-actor Yemen/Red Sea territorial escalation, both intensifying. threshold. Cut applied to 3mo/6mo/12mo only (-1 point each: 6→5, 23→22, 43→42); 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room) and 36mo held flat at 72 (a repeat regional strike and a same-theater territorial window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip (Neutral→Neutral equal-weight, Mild Bull→Mild Bull horizontal). stamp authority this set is **AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Sept 9 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-09_draft), prior cycle: CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship," centcom.mil) confirms US Navy's blockade line and extending into the Persian Gulf "in the coming days," with any vessel entering it placed on Iran's sanctions list; he separately said an Iran-Oman corridor agreement would be signed. independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to Iranian state media — clears the sufficiency bar. CENTCOM confirms both Iranian missile attempts were evaded and no US personnel harmed. line clause remains unfired — and Gulf of Oman/Kharg Island are both existing theater, so the widening-to-a-new-state clause does not fire either; this is a repeat pattern, not a fresh category of event. Sept 8 (Sept 9) for the first time since July 24 — confirmed by CNBC ("Brent crude tops \$100 as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries") and ABC News, trading ~\$100.44, +2.57% — a genuine escalation of the flip line, but a single-day intraday cross, not this pillar's own "sustained Brent >\$100" threshold, so it does not independently fire that clause either. Iran's Sept 6-7 SNSC "restricted zone" announcement reconfirmed the baseline logged it — coverage today still describes boundaries as unspecified, so it is not re-scored a second time. This is a continuation and intensification of the same escalation trend the Sept 6/8 cycles confirmed. **DOWN, modestly: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 7→6, 6mo 24→23, 12mo 44→43, 36mo 73→72.** No window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08_draft), prior cycle: Iran's SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced on-record (Iranian state TV, carried by Press TV and Tehran Times), Sept 6-7, that Iran's US Navy's blockade line and extending into the Persian Gulf "in the coming days," with any vessel entering it placed on Iran's sanctions list; he separately said an Iran-Oman corridor agreement would be signed. independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to Iranian state media — clears the sufficiency bar. This is a genuine new escalation of the event. executed: Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer states "further details, including the precise boundaries, have yet to be announced," and no zone had actually been declared as of this cycle's research cutoff. No DCAS US KIA remains 18 (unchanged since Sept 4), no widening to a further new state, and Brent closed ~\$97.29/bbl Sept 7 (tradingeconomics.com) — still short of \$100. GlobalSecurity's Day 192 (Sept 7) boarded (up from Day 190's 87/3/2 on Sept 3) is a continuation of the already-priced trend, not scored separately. No permanent Iran-Oman corridor deal has been signed. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 9→8, 6mo 27→25, 12mo 47→45, 36mo 74→73.** No window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral). delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft), prior cycle: CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil) now confirms the Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had explicitly withheld from the public. was materially more serious than known. US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers on Sept 5 — M/T Downy (permanently disabled off Kharg Island), M/T Stark 1 (permanently disabled near Jask), and M/T Belma — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (an aircraft carrier and a guided-missile destroyer); both ships evaded, no American personnel were harmed. Corroborated by Al Jazeera's own Sept 5 explainer. independent outlets in addition to CENTCOM's own release — this clears the sufficiency bar the Sept 5 baseline explicitly withheld on, and reveals a direct, unprovoked IRGC missile attack on US Navy vessels. Separately, Sept 6 (today) brings further IRGC claims — three more tankers, three "US-linked" vessels, and a US naval drone struck in the Strait (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews) — which are Iran's own claims. P; watch next cycle. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fire: DCAS still shows 18 confirmed US deaths (unchanged since Sept 4), Kharg Island/Jask/Gulf of Oman are all existing theater (not a new state) (markets closed Saturday) — still short of \$100. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 9→8, 6mo 27→25, 12mo 47→45, 36mo 74→73.** No window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar (CENTCOM's own release), and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral, checked both against the prior committed baseline and against an isolated same-BTO daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Sept 3-5 re-check, held flat: Iran fired a second retaliatory wave Sept 3 on Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE) — a US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit and no third night strike Sept 2, UAE struck earlier this war), so the widening-to-a-new-state clause still does not fire. Brent held roughly flat (~\$95.2-95.75 Sept 4), still short of \$100. Two developments logged, NOT used to move P: independent weapons experts who concluded the Sept 1 Kuhestak wedding-party strike was likely a direct hit by a US munition (JSOW-type glide-bomb fragments identified) — this upgrades the casualty count, corroborated by a primary Western wire service, but the US has still not accepted responsibility (VP Vance: "extremely skeptical," Sept 4, calling it under investigation), and the confirmation resolves attribution. describing new escalation, so it does not independently move P; (2) Sept 5 (today, developing): Iranian state/semi-official media (Fars) reported four missiles struck an Iranian oil tanker near Kharg Island, Iran's independent Western multi-source confirmation as of this research pass, so per the sufficiency rule this single-narrative claim is NOT used to move P. WATCH NEXT CYCLE: if independently confirmed, this would be a new escalation on Iran's core oil-export infrastructure, distinct from the Sept 1-2 tanker-hull strikes). Also noted: Iran reportedly warned the US that an Israeli move on Lebanon's Ali al-Taher ridge would trigger a "large-scale" attack, but no such attack has been confirmed as of this run — a live pending trigger, not a fired one. **P HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74. CORRECTION:** this cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 12, 2026" but never actually advanced to committed — a bug in that session, flagged here and not corrected retroactively.

Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2), this version: independently re-verified via WebSearch. The Sept 5 tanker report has firmed up considerably since the daily touch a few hours earlier: the Sept 5 tanker STARK 1, struck by four missiles ~6 nautical miles off Kharg Island per Tasnim (Iranian state media); separately, Iran International — a London-based Persian broadcaster editorially independent of the Iranian government — radio warnings ordering the crew to abandon ship before the strike, corroborating that a strike and warnings occurred. However, AP's own wire story on the incident is headlined "Iran accuses the US of targeting the tanker" — confirmed fact — and US Central Command had not issued any statement confirming or denying this specific strike as of this research pass (distinct from CENTCOM's on-the-record July 14-15 naval-blockade of the Strait of Hormuz). Belma was disabled via Hellfire-into-smokestack after ignoring warnings — that precedent is already priced in. Per the sufficiency rule, the identity of the striking party still needs either a primary confirmation or independent-of-the-accusing-party corroboration of that specific fact; Iran International's video corroborates that warnings were issued and a strike occurred, but does not independently confirm US authority to move P this cycle, consistent with the daily touch's conclusion a few hours earlier. WATCH NEXT CYCLE for CENTCOM confirmation or denial. None of the pillar's flip-line clauses independently fired this cycle (standing count remains 18 per GlobalSecurity Day 189), no widening to a further new state (Sept 3's Kuwait/UAE strikes were both repeat targets), and Brent held ~\$95-96/bbl Sept 3-4 — up roughly 9% v

sustained-flip threshold. **P HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74. Full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy regardless of move size (here, zero) — left for September 5, 2026.**

This is a light daily catch-up against the Sept 1 baseline (7/15/32/50/75, auto-stamped) — but it turned into the sharpest single-cycle move since the flip line itself fired Aug 30. **The load-bearing new fact** CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 targets across Iran — roughly 50x the scale of the single Aug 30 Larak Island strike — including, for the first time in this war, direct US strikes on Iranian government "tanker" policy. A US strike on Kuhestak, Hormozgan reportedly hit a wedding party (Hormozgan governor's office: 4 of at least 5 dead including a 4-year-old, 60+ injured) — CENTCOM has neither confirmed single-narrative-sourced at the core fact level, so it is NOT itself used to move P. It is reported as context for Iran's response: coordinated IRGC ballistic-missile and drone strikes Sept 2 on US-linked bases in — all repeat targets, so the widening-to-a-new-state flip-line clause does not fire. Multi-source corroborated: Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI, Al Jazeera, Yahoo, CBS News, RFE/RL.

P RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY: 1mo 7→1, 3mo 15→9, 6mo 32→27, 12mo 50→47, 36mo 75→74. Every window moved under 8 points, but this is the largest front-loaded cut since the Aug 30-31 flip-line fires a fresh flip-line clause (no confirmed US casualty, no confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, Brent short of \$100), but the already-fired "resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" clause is escaped by this move.

Still a **dip-watching pillar, not a panic-selling one** — the four-country retaliation hit repeat targets, most projectiles were intercepted, and no US casualty is confirmed. But the trajectory since Aug 30 is one of escalation and escalating exchange, and both sides are on-record threatening still-larger responses. A confirmed new US combat death, a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, or Brent sustaining a close above \$100 would cut.

Why this was originally left as a draft Sept 2, pending manual review: (1) the core wedding-casualty fact — the emotional and political driver of that day's four-country retaliation — is single-narrative-sourced, so confidence in that cycle's sizing was lower than for a cleanly multi-sourced primary event, and this pillar's own research chose not to self-approve a cut resting partly on it; (2) the jump in scale — strikes, versus two rocket/mine-launchers on Aug 30 — was a genuinely novel escalation this pillar's prior single-incident sizing precedents didn't cleanly cover; (3) both sides were on-record threatening more from Trump, "many times greater" from an Iranian military source), raising the cost of a miscalibrated cut. It also independently flipped the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band (Mild Bull → Neutral) with that day, this alone disqualified the set from delegated daily auto-stamp.

September 3, 2026 update: Alex reviewed this cycle's research (delivered as PDFs Sept 2) and widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy in CLAUDE.md: a call-band flip and the size of a move are not the holds are a genuine research-capability gap that cycle, or an unresolved verification inconsistency. This cycle had neither: the research was multi-sourced, and the single-narrative wedding-casualty claim was confirmed. Nothing about the underlying facts, sourcing, or the sizing of the cut changed — only the stamping threshold did. **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026.**

Historical note: the paragraph above was the Sept 2 cycle's original manual-review flag, superseded by the Sept 3 auto-stamp policy widening and, again, by this cycle's own auto-stamp. Left here for the audit trail of any cycle if reviewed — the master blend recomputes.

What Changed Since Last Check

Light daily catch-up, September 12, 2026 (score set 2026-09-12_draft) — checking for changes since the Sept 11 committed baseline (2026-09-11_draft, light daily catch-up, auto-stamped).

- ★ ★ **NEW — a second global oil chokepoint moves from "under threat" to under adversary-aligned control.** Houthi forces, having seized Mocha Sept 10, captured Dhubab and Murad by the internationally recognized government — giving them the ENTIRE Red Sea coastline, and separately seized Mayyun (Perim) Island inside the Bab al-Mandeb strait, with fighting continuing for the National, National Herald — 6+ independent). Materially more severe than the Sept 10 baseline's "closing in" characterization.
- **Logged, honest counterweight:** Saudi Crown Prince MBS twice asked the President for direct US strikes on the Houthis and was refused (intelligence/targeting support offered instead).
- ★ ★ **NEW — UKMTO Warning 133-26 confirms four projectiles struck two more vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman Sept 10, one set afire** (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill corroborated).
- **Logged, not scored (single-source):** IRGC's own claim of a strike on a US Navy Saildrone near the Strait entrance — no US/CENTCOM confirmation found.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70** (from 1/4/20/40/71) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. Neither the widening clause nor the flip-line clause fires — this is a severity escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment, sized moderately larger than the routine 1-point daily touches given the scale of the underlying news. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily COMMITTED baseline.**

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW — Houthi forces launched a significant ballistic-missile-and-drone attack directly on Saudi Arabian soil Sept 8, hitting Saudi Aramco energy facilities — including the 400,000 bbl/d Mubaiyah, Jazan, and Najran.** Saudi Arabia's Energy Ministry confirmed several energy facilities and utilities temporarily halted; Saudi authorities confirmed 73 wounded (NPR, NBC News, Bloomberg, Daily Caller, SRN News, plus the Saudi Energy Ministry's own statement). Saudi Arabia is a repeat target — the widening clause does not fire, but this is materially more severe than prior Saudi Arabia.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent crude closes above \$100/bbl for a THIRD consecutive session, moving decisively to \$105.71-\$108** — the highest since May 19 (Reuters-linked wires, Bloomberg, Energy Intelligence) attributed to the Sept 8 Aramco strikes plus continuing US-Iran tanker exchanges — the closest this war has come to a sustained >\$100 close, still not formally called fired.
- ★ ★ **NEW — the IAEA Board of Governors votes 23-3-8 Sept 9 to refer Iran to the UN Security Council over nuclear non-proliferation breaches** — the first such referral in two decades (New Straits Times, Al-Monitor, Free Malaysia Today, CDM Press). Iran's Azizi threatens on-record retaliation Sept 11, single-source, not used to move P.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, larger than the recent 1-point touches, to 1/3/19/38/69** (from 1/5/22/42/72) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -3, 12mo -4, 36mo -3. No US casualty, no widening to a new state, Brent's third session not yet a formally sustained close). No window moved more than 4 points, master call band unchanged everywhere — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily COMMITTED baseline.**

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base Sept 9, retaliating for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike.** Jordan's armed forces confirmed 73 casualties (Al Jazeera, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan's own military statement). Jordan is a repeat target — the widening clause does not fire; no casualties on either side — the flip-line clause does not fire.
- ★ **Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait,** a second global chokepoint distinct from Hormuz (The Media Line, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail). Same actor/theater already priced; no strait closure actually confirmed.
- **Brent crude traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session** (above \$101 Sept 9, ~\$101.25 Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross, but still short of a sustained close above \$100.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from 1/6/23/43/72) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -1, 12mo -1, 36mo held flat. No flip-line clause independent of a new state, Brent above \$100 but not yet a sustained close). No window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily COMMITTED baseline.**

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 9 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-09_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Kharak) — with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days.** Corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's "After Iran Targets Another American Warship"). Both Iranian missile attempts evaded, no US personnel harmed.
- **Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24,** trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) on U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strike fears (CNBC, ABC News) — the closest that cycle has come to a sustained close.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72** (from 1/7/24/44/73) — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily COMMITTED baseline.**

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announces on-record, Sept 6-7, that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning any independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to Iranian state media (Press TV, Tehran Times) — clears the sufficient condition for a sustained close.**
- **This is a threat of intent, not yet executed:** Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer says boundaries have yet to be announced; no zone has actually been declared. A parallel claim of an imminent strike is also present.

- ★ **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73** (from 1/8/25/45/73) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -1, 12mo -1, 36mo held flat. No flip-line clause independently fired this week (no confirmed new US combat death, no widening to a further new state, Brent short of \$100). No window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** (no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated daily authority stamped)".

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM's own press release confirmed the Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had withheld: THREE Iranian tankers struck (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kylo) in retaliation for an Iranian strike on a US ship** (Sept 5, 2026). Corroborated by Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC, and 5+ other outlets. Both US ships evaded, no American personnel harmed.
- ★ **Sept 6's single-source IRGC claims of further strikes on 3 more tankers, 3 "US-linked" vessels, and a US naval drone** (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews) remained US-unconfirmed — not used to move P.
- ★ **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73** (from 1/9/27/47/74) — no window moved more than 2 points, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated daily authority (no window moved more than 2 points, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated daily authority stamped)".

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-05_draft2, committed by Alex), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran fired a second retaliatory wave Sept 3 on Kuwait and UAE, both REPEAT targets.** A US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit; the widening-to-a-new-state clause was not used to move P.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Sept 5: the Iranian-flagged NITC tanker STARK 1 reportedly hit by four missiles ~6nm off Kharg Island.** Iran's Tasnim (state media) makes the claim; Iran International (independent) corroborated the claim; AP's own wire story is headlined "Iran accuses the US of targeting a tanker" (an accusation, not a confirmed fact); CENTCOM has not confirmed or denied it. NOT used to move P. NEXT CYCLE.
- ★ **Reuters shared images/video with four independent weapons experts corroborating the Sept 1 Kuhestak wedding-strike casualty claim as likely a direct US-munition hit** — resolved the widening-to-a-new-state clause; escalation; US has not accepted responsibility. NOT used to move P.
- ★ **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74.** No flip-line clause independently fired this week (no confirmed new US combat death, no widening to a further new state, Brent short of \$100). No window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **COMMITTED BY ALEX SEPTEMBER 5, 2026.**
- ★ **Correction:** the same-day earlier 2026-09-05_draft's commit message claimed it was auto-stamped, but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced — a bug in that session. Flagged for Alex, not corrected retroactively.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 2 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-02_draft, committed), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW — CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran, ~50x the scale of the Aug 30 strike.** IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, comms sites, and oil tankers. Source: Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI.
- ★ ★ **NEW — for the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms),** under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy.
- ★ ★ **NEW, SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact — a US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Kuhestak, Hormozgan.** Hormozgan governor's office: 4 of at least 5 dead (incl. the bride). US confirmed nor denied it. NOT independently used to move P — reported as context for the retaliation it triggered.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran's IRGC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated strikes on FOUR countries at once: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait.** All four are repeat targets — does NOT independently fire the widening-to-a-new-state clause; projectiles intercepted; no confirmed new US combat death.
- ★ **NEW — Brent rose ~5% Tue Sept 1 (best session in 5 weeks) to ~\$95-96.6; WTI ~\$91-92** — still short of the \$100 flip line. Both sides now on-record threatening larger future action (Trump's "many times greater," per CNBC).
- ★ **BTC traded at \$76,581.44 (Sept 2)** — down from \$78,038.78 (Sept 1, Bitstamp), a real risk-off move.
- ★ **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY to 1/9/27/47/74** (from 7/15/32/50/75) — 1mo -6, 3mo -6, 6mo -5, 12mo -3, 36mo -1; front-loaded, kept under the 8-point threshold, but this week the widening-to-a-new-state clause was not used to move P. line-firing cut. Originally left as draft Sept 2 for Alex's manual review (single-narrative wedding-casualty fact, genuinely novel scale, both sides threatening larger future action, and the master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026** once Alex widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy so a call-band flip and move size no longer withhold the stamp by themselves.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-01_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week, Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting.** The Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity was struck by three unknown projectiles (one hit the engine room, ballast tank hit); no casualties. Follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25).
- ★ **Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; the UAE Ministry of Defense DENIES the base was targeted while CONFIRMING a cross-border drone incursion.** The drone was shot down over UAE territorial waters, approaching from Iran — corroborated by CBS News, Al Jazeera, Breitbart, Yahoo, Jerusalem Post, ABC News, Seatrade Maritime, and Iran International.
- ★ **President Trump said on-record Aug 31 he is still weighing further strikes on Iran,** calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo) — not a de-escalation signal.
- ★ **Brent continued higher into Sept 1 (~+2% Tuesday, multiple market-desk reports)** — second straight cycle of gains on this news thread; Jordan struck again Aug 30-31 but remained a repeat target.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$78,038.78 (Sept 1)** — down from \$78,447.16 (Aug 31, Bitstamp).
- ★ **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75** (from 9/17/34/51/75) — 1mo -2, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -1, 36mo flat; no single new fact independently fired a fresh flip-line; working assumption that one resumed-strike night was not yet a sustained campaign. **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated daily authority: light daily touch, no window moved >2 points, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) (Mild Bull), sourcing well above the sufficiency bar.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-08-31_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **Resumed direct US strike on Iranian territory, Aug 30, CONFIRMED via on-record CENTCOM spokesperson (Capt. Tim Hawkins) plus 20+ independent outlets.** US forces struck two Iranian ships (one hit the engine room, ballast tank hit); observing prep to fire sea mines into the Strait — first acknowledged US strike on Iran since Jul 29, ending the ~28-30-night clean streak. **Fired this pillar's own pre-declared downside flip line** (no window moved >2 points, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated daily authority: light daily touch, no window moved >2 points, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken").
- ★ **IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases, Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED via Jordan's own military statement.** King Hussein and Al-Azraq airbases targeted; "significant damage," unconfirmed by US/Jordan beyond interception; IRGC confirmed casualties at Larak (no precise toll); no confirmed US casualty from either event.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$78,447.16 (Aug 31)** — up from \$77,666.16 (Aug 29, Bitstamp).
- ★ **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN, front-loaded, to 9/17/34/51/75** (from 14/22/38/54/76) — 1mo -5, 3mo -5, 6mo -4, 12mo -3, 36mo -1, sized to a single resumed-strike-night shock. **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated daily authority: light daily touch, no window moved >2 points, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) (Mild Bull), sourcing well above the sufficiency bar.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-29_draft, held P flat, left as draft, now superseded), for continuity:

- ★ **"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov (sb0613, sb0614) and an OFAC recent-actions entry.** ~60 entities/individuals in Malaysia, UAE, Singapore, and Switzerland under five EO 13902 sectoral determinations; corroborated by state.gov, TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes, law-firm alerts. **For the first time, digital crypto addresses (BTC/ETH/TRON) listed.** Real, primary-confirmed, crypto-specific — unlike the "promised, not landed" sanctions rhetoric this pillar discounted through Aug 22. Continued to move P.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor, Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of fm.gov.om/en/53722.** A genuine upgrade: every prior pillar had assumed a temporary corridor. Terms: temporary 7-mile joint navigational corridor, joint mine-clearing project, continuing talks toward a permanent corridor. Still "temporary" — Iran its own ministry co-hosts the statement. No fee terms disclosed.
- ★ **NEW — two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents, Aug 24 (off Oman, engine-room damage, disabled, no casualties, UKMTO) and Aug 27 (fire onboard, extinguished, crew rescued).** Already-priced pattern.
- ★ **NEW — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing, Aug 28:** Iranian sea mines cleared from the shipping lanes; ~1,500 vessels transited since blockade enforcement lifted; exports since blockade resumed (UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire).
- ★ **NEW — IMO's six-month casualty count settles at 19-20 dead** across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the prior 15-19 range.

- **NEW — Trump announced Aug 25 the Strait had been demined**, with a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 news.
- **NEW — first confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week** for the week of Aug 17-23 (USNI News/Lloyd's List) — 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week.
- **NEW, FLAGGED AND NOT USED — an IRGC spokesman's Aug 26 claim of an Iran-Oman Hormuz revenue-sharing agreement** (Sepah News, Iranian state military source) is unconfirmed; the countries' joint statement describes only an "interim framework" with no fees — single-source, explicitly not the US-accepted deal this pillar's flip line requires.
- **Brent eased for a SECOND straight week:** ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28), down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21) — moving further from the \$100 flip line.
- **No new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29;** no new US/CENTCOM strikes found (GlobalSecurity Day-181 tracker, 28th consecutive clean night).
- **BTC closed at \$77,666.16 (Aug 29)** — up modestly from \$77,266.84 (Aug 22, Bitstamp).
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76** — the confirmed sanctions escalation and the confirmed Oman corridor upgrade roughly offset; neither independently clears the sufficiency stamp (full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority).

Carried forward — the abandoned Aug 28 daily catch-up draft (2026-08-28_draft), for audit continuity: that draft first logged the two Aug 24/27 tanker incidents, Trump's Aug 25 demining claim, and the IRGC revenue-sharing claim, but then was abandoned, so this Aug 29 cycle re-researched and re-verified all of it fresh (see above) rather than carry it forward on trust. Treated as not-delivered, same discipline as the Aug 17-21 gap.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 22 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2, committed by Alex Aug 23), for continuity: Background, for completeness: Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts were each researched but never delivered, so this Aug 22 full weekly refresh independently re-researched the pillar again and ran a second, dedicated adversarial pass.

- **Aug 17/18/20 drafts (never delivered):** held flat, then cut to 17/25/38/54/76, then cut further to 16/24/38/54/76 on the lapsed MoU window and the UAE missile claim (framed as a "novel episode" and archived).
- **Aug 21 (partially delivered, then abandoned):** a session began delivering the Aug 20 draft's numbers but updated only 2 of 6 reports and never ran render/selfcheck/archive/commit — treated as not-delivered, same discipline as the Aug 17-21 gap.
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — a fatal strike in the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign**, Aug 17-18: bulker Minoan Dignity's chief engineer killed, 7+ independent sources. That draft first (wrongly) claimed a "fatal strike" and was corrected to "roughly the 18th such death" — a toll this report had never surfaced before.
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22**, the tanker Amara, boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17, still detained Aug 19. Confirmed accurate on adversarial re-check.
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — CORRECTION: the UAE missile claim is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE** as prior drafts framed it; UAE was hit in April and at Fujairah May 4. The "novel episode" review hold was retired; re-confirmed again this cycle.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle (draft2) — casualty toll re-verified as a range, not a point figure.** Second dedicated adversarial pass cross-checked Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (100+ sources) and the "Middle East Highlighted Incidents" page (19, but broader-Middle-East scoped, not clean Hormuz) — honest toll is a **15-19 range (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers)**. This softer range was more precise than the sources support; corrected everywhere in this report.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle (draft2) — the UAE missile claim reconciles to one episode, not two.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) describing the Aug 18 episode initially flagged by this cycle's adversarial pass as a possible miss; confirmed on reconciliation to be the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline.
- **★ NEW this cycle (draft2) — no new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22** on independent re-checking; CENTCOM's blockade tally continues climbing incrementally (68 vessels redirected, vs. 58 as of Aug 22; Brent ~\$93-95/bbl (Aug 20-21), a second straight weekly gain, still under the \$100 flip line.
- **No new US/CENTCOM strikes since Aug 1; sanctions remain mostly rhetoric** (one narrow OFAC-adjacent Hezbollah designation Aug 22, not the promised Iran-economy package); Iran said it would not respond.
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 (Aug 22)** — +7.4% vs. the Aug 20 close of \$71,882.92, a further move against the direction of this pillar's own evidence — logged as an honesty check (The Claim), not a score change.
- **Score decision (draft2):** versus the Aug 16 committed baseline: 1mo 20 → **14** · 3mo 28 → **22** · 6mo 41 → **38** · 12mo 56 → **54** · 36mo 77 → **76** — unchanged from the Aug 22 morning draft; full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated daily auto-stamp authority); **COMMITTED BY ALEX August 23, 2026** after review. See My Decision for the full reasoning.

Sources

Retrieved & graded September 12, 2026, light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft; earlier sources below still stand for facts not re-checked this cycle) — click and judge the quality yourself. Official/primary sources first, then research cycle's research: Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, and National Herald on the Houthi seizure of Yemen's Red Sea coastline and Mayyun Island; UKMTO Warning 133-26 plus Gulf News/Maritime Executive/The Hill on the Houthi seizure of the Red Sea coastline; Brent's Sept 12 settle.

- **September 12 light daily catch-up (this cycle):** Al Jazeera ("Can the Houthis close the Red Sea after seizing the Yemen coast?," Sept 11) — Houthi capture of the entire Red Sea coastline · NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National — forces seizing Dhubbab, Murad, and Mayyun (Perim) Island, fighting continuing for Zuqar Island; Saudi Crown Prince MBS's request for US strikes on the Houthis refused · UKMTO Warning 133-26 (1910 UTC Sept 10, official warning) · Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill (Sept 9) — Iran attacked 10 vessels near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers), largest declared wave of shipping attacks of the war; at least one seafarer killed, one missing · GlobalSecurity — Sallidrone strike near the Strait entrance, no US confirmation found · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$77,289.66 (Sept 12) vs. \$77,063.25 (Sept 11) vs. \$77,993.99 (Sept 10).
- **September 11 light daily catch-up:** Rigzone (Bloomberg wire, Sept 10) — Brent ended Thursday up more than 6% above \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday, highest in nearly four months; WTI closed above \$102, up ~\$104.36 Friday, ~3.04% on the day, ~9% higher on the week; cites Hormuz diplomacy and the IEA's 2.5 mb/d 2026 demand-contraction forecast as the counterweight · Vantage Markets, NAI500 (Sept 10) — corroborated U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill (Sept 9) — Iran attacked 10 vessels near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers), largest declared wave of shipping attacks of the war; at least one seafarer killed, one missing · GlobalSecurity — returned HTTP 403 this cycle, so its content is cited only as surfaced in search summaries (flagged as a degraded pull, not used alone to move P).
- **September 10 light daily catch-up:** Al Jazeera (Sept 9), MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org (Iran War 2026 Day 194) — corroborating reporting on Jordan's own military statement confirming the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at the Jordanian coast, fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties · The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail — corroborating reporting on the Houthi seizure of the Yemeni port of Mocha, a separate report of a Houthi seizure of the Red Sea coastline · Brent above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9, first time since May · TradingEconomics — Brent ~\$101.25 Thursday Sept 10 · standing DoD casualty records (checked directly) — 18 confirmed as of Sept 4, unchanged; a separate report of a Houthi seizure of the Red Sea coastline and rejected as uncorroborated · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$77,993.99 (Sept 10) vs. \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8).
- **September 9 light daily catch-up:** CENTCOM (centcom.mil) — official press release, "US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship" (Sept 8, primary source): M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Houshmand · NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org — corroborating reporting on the same CENTCOM statement and the two IRGC missile attempts on a US Navy warship, both evaded · CNBC — "Brent crude tops \$100" (Sept 9) · ABC News — corroborating Brent ~\$100.44 intraday, +2.57% · standing DoD casualty records (checked directly) — 18 confirmed as of Sept 4, unchanged · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$77,993.99 (Sept 10).
- **September 8 light daily catch-up:** Press TV, Tehran Times (Iranian state media) — Mohsen Rezaei's (SNSC secretary) on-record statement, Sept 6-7, announcing intent to declare a "restricted zone" from the US Navy's 18th fleet entering it, and an Iran-Oman corridor agreement "in the coming days" · Al Jazeera ("Can Iran enforce a restricted zone in the Strait of Hormuz?," Sept 7 explainer, noting boundaries not yet announced), The Hill, RTE, ANI, GlobalSecurity.org — corroborating reporting on the same Rezaei statement · GlobalSecurity.org — Iran War 2026 Day 192 update (Sept 7); blockade count 92 vessels redirected, 3 disabled, 2 boarded (vs. Day 190's 87/3 disabled, 2 boarded) · Brent ~\$97.29/bbl Sept 7 close · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7) vs. \$80,338.98 (Sept 6).
- **September 6 light daily catch-up:** CENTCOM (centcom.mil) — official press release, "CENTCOM Destroys 3 IRGC Oil Tankers After Iran Targets 2 U.S. Navy Warships" (Sept 5, primary source) · Al Arabiya English, Jerusalem Post, Euronews (Sept 6, Iranian forces targeting a US naval drone) — Iran's own Sept 6 follow-on claims, not US-confirmed, NOT used to move P · standing DoD casualty records (checked directly) — 18 confirmed as of Sept 4, unchanged · Brent ~\$96/bbl Friday Sept 4 close (US/UK markets closed Saturday Sept 6, no new print) · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,929.30 (Sept 6) vs. \$79,646.11 (Sept 5).
- **September 3-5 re-check:** GlobalSecurity — Iran War 2026 Day 188-189 updates (Sept 3-4): Iran's second retaliatory wave hit Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE), both repeat targets; a US official confirmed the strike, misstatement to reaffirm the standing US KIA count at 18 · Reuters (via Spokesman-Review, Nukta, Tribune, TBS News, unna) — four independent weapons experts' forensic analysis of images/video verified by Reuters, hit by a US munition (JSOW-type glide-bomb fragments); VP Vance's "extremely skeptical" comment, Sept 4 · Times of Israel liveblog, Euronews, Newswire.lk — Sept 5 Iranian-media-only (Fars) report of a tanker strike near the Strait of Hormuz · Critical Threats/ISW — Iran's warning that an Israeli move on Lebanon's Ali al-Taher ridge would trigger a "large-scale attack" on Israel; IDF took the ridge Sept 3, no such attack confirmed as of this run.
- **September 2 light daily catch-up — CENTCOM-confirmed strikes plus multi-source reporting on the retaliation:** Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI — corroborating reporting on the CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes on the Strait of Hormuz, radar, mine-laying capability, comms sites, anti-ship cruise-missile/drone launchers) and the first-ever direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy · Al Jazeera, CBS News, RFE/RL — corroborating reporting on Iran's IRGC Sept 2 coordinated strikes on Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, and Kuwait, interception rates, and the absence of a confirmed new US combat death · CNBC — Trump's "significant" military source's "many times greater" quote · multiple market-desk reports — Brent ~+5% Tue Sept 1 (best session in 5 weeks) to ~\$95-96.6, WTI ~\$91-92 · Bitstamp — BTC \$76,581.44 (Sept 2) vs. \$78,038.78 (Sept 1).
- **September 1 light daily catch-up — UKMTO log plus multi-source reporting:** UKMTO — Senegal Prosperity incident log, Aug 31 (VLCC struck by three unknown projectiles ~17nm NE of Khasab, Oman; port side, engine room damaged) · Breitbart, Yahoo, Jerusalem Post, ABC News, Seatrade Maritime, Iran International — corroborating reporting on the Al Minhad Air Base drone-strike claim (Iran's army) and the UAE Ministry of Defense's on-record denial of the claim.

- **The oil waiver:** CBS — GL X1 waiver rescission (July 7) · Axios — waiver revocation (July 7) · The Hill — sanctions detail (July 7).

- **The prices:** Fortune — Brent ~\$76.00–76.80 (July 10) · Kitco/Reuters — oil fell as markets weigh strikes (July 9) · Sunday Guardian — Brent ~\$76 / WTI <\$72 (July 10; weaker source) · CNBC — Brent \$78.02 / WTI \$73.52 (hull value (July 9) · The New Arab — JMIC "severe" advisory · LMA — insurance availability vs safety concerns · *(Hormuz traffic magnitude conflicts across outlets — ~50% of pre-war vs ~92% drop — transponders off; pre- — single-source)* · CoinDesk — BTC steady above \$62K (July 9) · CoinDesk — BTC to ~\$64K on chips/yen, not Iran (July 10) · Fortune — BTC ~\$61.7K (July 6, pre-escalation) · CoinDesk — ~\$450M liquidations (July 8).
- **The odds (sentiment only, not fact):** Blockchain.News — invasion odds 11.5% → 14.5% (~July 8 print) · Blockchain.News — Hormuz-normal-by-July odds collapse to 4.5% (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · *Direct Polyn 2027" relayed via secondary aggregators only — inconsistent snapshots ~14.5% (Jul 8) → ~15.5% (~Jul 10) → ~17% (most recent), inconsistency itself flagged. "MoU withdrawal by Jul 31" reads (~5–7%, dated ~Jul 3–5) and re-verified this week.*